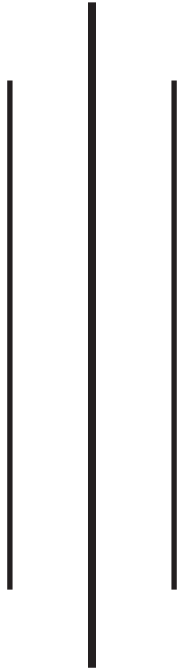


વિમર્શ મનોવિજ્ઞાન સ્મારિકા



વિમર્શ મનોવિજ્ઞાન સ્નાતકોત્તર ડિપ્લોમા ૨૦૧૧ સમૂહ
Post Graduate Diploma in Counseling Psychology 2021 Batch

વિમર્શ મનોવિજ્ઞાન સ્મારિકા



વિમર્શ મનોવિજ્ઞાન સ્નાતકોત્તર ડિપ્લોમા ૨૦૭૭ સમૂહ
Post Graduate Diploma in Counseling Psychology 2021 Batch

विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्मारिका

प्रकाशन	: २०७९ वैशाख
सम्पादक	: रवीन्द्र भट्टराई
प्रकाशक	: विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्नातकोत्तर डिप्लोमा २०७७ समूह त्रिभुवन विश्वविद्यालय त्रिचन्द्र बहुमुखी क्याम्पस मनोविज्ञान तथा दर्शन विभाग घण्टाघर, काठमाडौं
मुद्रण	: एक्सिस प्रिन्टर्स प्रा. लि. न्यूप्लाजा, काठमाडौं फोन नं. : ०१-४५३६८६१



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(स्थापित १९७५ वि.सं.)

फोन : ४-२४४०४७

SofDk; kdlvsfjsfoffno
सरस्वती सदन, काठमाडौं ।

पत्र संख्या :-

शुभकामना



भावनाप्रधान प्राणी हुनाले मान्छेका लागि सबैभन्दा महत्वपूर्ण मन नै हुन्छ। शान्त, स्थीर तथा क्रियाशील मन निकै उत्पादनमूलक हुन्छ । अशान्त, अस्थिर, चिन्तित, शोक र रिसले भरिएको मन समाज र आफु व्यक्ति स्वयंका लागि पनि अहितकर हुन्छ । आधुनिक जीवनशैलीका कारण मान्छेले मानसिक स्वास्थ्य गुमाउँदै छ । इन्टरनेट तथा मोबाइलको प्रयोग लतभै बढेर एकाध घरका परिवारहरु पनि पराइभै भएका छन् । बालबालिका तथा बृद्धबृद्धासँग एक बचन मिठो बोलेर हालचाल सोध्ने मान्छेको अभाव हुँदैछ । प्रतिस्पर्धी जीवनशैली तथा एक्लोपनले मान्छेले आफ्नो मान्छेपन गुमाउँदै छ ।

यस्तो अवस्थामा, विमर्श मनोविज्ञहरुले तिनको मानसिक स्वास्थ्यका क्षेत्रमा ठूलो सहयोग गर्न सक्छन् । यसैले विमर्श मनोविज्ञान (काउन्सिलिङ साइकोलोजी) आजको आवश्यकता हो । विगत १९ वर्षदेखि त्रिचन्द्र बहुमुखी क्याम्पसले निरन्तर परामर्श मनोविज्ञानमा डिप्लोमा तहका प्रशिक्षित जनशक्ति उत्पादन गरिराएको छ । यसबाट उत्पादित मनोविमर्शकर्मीहरुले जनताको मानसिक स्वास्थ्यमा योगदान गरिरहेका छन् । मनोविज्ञान तथा दर्शनशास्त्र विभागमा विमर्श मनोविज्ञानका विद्यार्थीहरु (२०७७ समूह) ले आफ्नै पहलमा स्मारिका प्रकाशन हुन लागेको कुराले अत्यन्तै खुसी लागेको छ । स्मारिकाको सफल प्रकाशनका लागि शुभकामना व्यक्त गर्दछु ।

कोरोनाको प्रतिकूल अवस्थामा समेत अविचलित रहेर शिक्षादीक्षा दिने प्राध्यापकहरु र कहिले अनलाइन त कहिले अफलाइनमा रहेर अत्यन्त जागरुकता र अभिरुचिपूर्वक शिक्षा ग्रहण गर्ने सबै विद्यार्थीहरुमा धन्यवाद दिन चाहन्छु । त्यस्तो परिवेशमा अध्ययन गरेको २०७७ को समूहबाट स्मारिका प्रकाशित गरिनुलाई एउटा सार्थक प्रयास ठानेको छु। प्रकाशन गर्ने विद्यार्थीहरु तथा विभागीय प्राध्यापकहरुलाई हार्दिक धन्यवाद, बधाई एवं शुभकामना दिन चाहन्छु। यो स्मारिकाले क्याम्पस तथा यो ब्याचका विद्यार्थीहरुबीच एकआपसमा व्यक्तिगत एवं व्यावसायिक सम्पर्क कायम राख्न सफल हुने नै छ भन्ने आशा राख्दै पुनः यो सुन्दर स्मारिका प्रकाशन गर्नु भएकोमा सम्पूर्ण विद्यार्थीहरुलाई म व्यक्तिगत तथा क्याम्पस परिवारका तर्फबाट धन्यवाद ज्ञापन गर्दछु ।

प्रा.डा. सुनिल अधिकारी
क्याम्पस प्रमुख

शुभ-सन्देश



मनः करोति पापानि मनो लिप्येत पातकैः।
मनश्च तन्मना भूत्वा न पुण्यैकक च पातकैः॥

मनले नै अनेकाँ कमसल चिन्तन गर्छ र तेसैका कारण समस्यामा पर्छ । मनलाई स्वास्थ्य राखेपछि सम्पूर्ण कर्महरू सहज हुन्छन् र बिग्रने र सप्रिने चिन्ता रहन्न (ज्ञानसङ्कलिनीतन्त्रम्- ४५)।

प्रेम, घृणा, काम, क्रोध, लोभ, मोह, डर, चिन्ता, शोक तथा अन्य थुप्रै भावनाहरूले मान्छेको जीवनशैली प्रभावित भइरहेको हुन्छ । नदेखिने तर हरेक पल मान्छेसँगै रहेर प्रभावित गरिरहने भावनाहरूको संयुक्त अवस्था नै मन हो । महर्षि पतञ्जलिले मनका भावनाहरूलाई "चित्तवृत्ति" भन्ने पहिचान दिएका छन् भने ज्ञानसङ्कलिनी तन्त्रले मन नै सुखदुःखको अनुभूति दिने अवस्था हो भनेको छ र काम, क्रोध, मोह, लाज र लोभ यी पाँच वटा प्रमुख भावना हुन् जुन आकाशतत्त्वका गुण हुन् (ज्ञानसङ्कलिनीतन्त्रम्-२४) भन्दै मानसिक भावहरूको स्वरूप आकाश भैं विशाल भएको इङ्गित गरेको छ ।

अभिभावकहरूले आफ्ना बालबालिकालाई "प्रतिस्पर्धी" (Competitive) बनेर "विजयी" बन्न अभिप्रेरित गरिरहेका छन् । यो नै आज तथाकथित आधुनिक जीवनशैलीको यथार्थ भैरहेको छ प्रतियोगितामा विजयी बन्ने पर्ने महत्वाकाङ्क्षा र उपलब्ध अवसरबिचको ठूलो खाडलका कारण के बालबालिका, के युवा, के प्रौढ, के बृद्धबृद्धा सबैमा मानसिक तनाव (Stress) बढेको बढे छ । अनन्त महत्वाकाङ्क्षा र उपलब्ध स्रोतको अभावले मानिसमा निराशा, आक्रोश तथा अस्थिरता जीवनको अङ्ग बनेर मनभित्र भित्रिएको छ । सुखी बन्ने प्रतियोगितामा मान्छेले आफ्ना मानसिक शान्ति, सन्तोष तथा पूर्णता गुमाउँदै लगेको छ । भावनाप्रधान मानिसको अहिलेको जीवनशैली यस्तै छ ।

आज मान्छेको लागि सबैभन्दा ठूलो चुनौतीनै मानसिक स्वास्थ्य बनेको छ । सुखी तथा खुसी जीवनका लागि अनन्त प्रतियोगिता गर्दा गुमाएका जीवनका अमूल्य क्षणहरू पुनः प्राप्ति गर्न चाहन्छ भने आफ्ना सन्तानले आफुलेभैं सुखको खोजिमा गुमाएका आनन्दका क्षणहरू गुमाउन नपरोस् भन्ने चाहन्छ । आज मानसिक स्वास्थ्य र प्रतियोगितापूर्ण जीवनशैलीका बिचमा सन्तुलनको खाँचो छ । विगत त्रिचन्द्र बहुमुखी क्याम्पसले १९ वर्षदेखि विमर्श मनोविज्ञान विषयमा स्नातकोत्तर डिप्लोमा तहको शिक्षाका माध्यमबाट मनोविमर्शसेवा प्रदान गर्न सक्ने जनशक्ति उत्पादन गरिराएको छ । नेपालीहरूको मानसिक सुस्वास्थ्यका लागि यसबाट राष्ट्र टेवा पुगेको छ र प्रशिक्षित जनशक्तिले देशविदेशमा मानसिक स्वास्थ्यमा आफ्नो सेवा प्रदान गरिरहेको छ ।

यसै निरन्तरतामा २०७६-७७ ब्याचले कोरोनाको कहरबिचमा धेरै कुरा सिकेको छ । सत्य के हो भने कोरोनाकालको प्रतिकूलताले यो ब्याच सबैभन्दा बढी प्रभावित रह्यो। अनलाइन तथा अफलाइन दुवै विधिबाट शिक्षा लिँदै गर्दा यस ब्याचका विद्यार्थीहरूले सर्वसाधारणसहित कोरोनाका त्रासद कारण उत्पन्न मानसिक समस्याहरूलाई प्रत्यक्ष अनुभव गरेका छन् । कोरोनाले निम्त्याएको त्रास, मानसिक पीडा तथा समस्याहरूको प्रत्यक्ष अनुभव गर्न पाएकोले यो ब्याचले साच्चिकै "मानवीय मनोविज्ञानसँग" परिचित हुने मौका बढी पाएको छ । त्यो कहर खुसीको विषय थिएन तर सिक्नका लागि पढ्ने पढाउने दुवैले यसलाई एउटा अध्ययनका लागि अवसरकै रूपमा उपयोग गरियो जुन सकारात्मक पक्ष बन्यो ।

कोरोनाको कहरले गर्दा समयमा प्रकाशित हुन नसकेको यो स्मारिका यशस्वी ब्याचले आफ्नै पराक्रम तथा सहपाठीहरूको आपसी सहकार्यबाट प्रकाशित गर्न सफल भएको छ। यो स्मारिकाले यस ब्याचका सहपाठीहरूका बिचमा व्यक्तिगत, कार्यक्षेत्रगत तथा एकआपसको मानसिक एकतालाई अझै बलियो बनाउने छ । स्मारिका प्रकाशन गर्नुभएकोमा यसका सम्पादक, लेखक, प्रकाशक समूह र सहयोगी सबैलाई बधाई र धन्यवाद ज्ञापन गर्दछु । साथै, ब्याचका सम्पूर्ण विद्यार्थीहरूको उत्तरोत्तर प्रगतिका लागि हार्दिक शुभकामना ।

डा. गोविन्दशरण उपाध्याय

संयोजक

विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्नातकोत्तर डिप्लोमा कार्यक्रम
मनोविज्ञान तथा दर्शनशास्त्र विभाग

अग्रलेख

धेरै मानिसले स्वस्थ रहनु भनेको शरीरमा कुनै प्रकारको रोग नहुनु हो भन्ने बुझ्दछन् । हाम्रो मुलुकको स्वास्थ्यसेवा प्रणालीले पनि व्यवहारमा स्वास्थ्यलाई त्यही रूपमा बुझ्ने-बुझाउने गरेजस्तो लाग्छ । यथार्थमा स्वास्थ्य भनेको यति साँघुरो अवधारणा होइन । स्वस्थ मानिस त्यो हो जो शारीरिक, मानसिक/मनोवैज्ञानिक र सामाजिक रूपमै हट्टाकट्टा वा तन्दुरुस्त छ। मनोविज्ञान प्राकृतिक र सामाजिक दुवै विज्ञानको साभा ज्ञानप्रणालीमा विकसित विषय हो। यो विषय नजोडिने कुनै पेसा क्षेत्र छैन । चिकित्सा होस् कि वाणिज्य, न्याय-कानून होस् कि प्रशासन, शिक्षा होस् कि व्यवसाय सबै फाँटमा काम गर्ने मानिसलाई मनोविज्ञानको केही न केही ज्ञान हुन आवश्यक नै हुन्छ ।

स्वस्थ भएर बाँच्नका लागि मानिसले व्यक्तित्व विकासका चरणमा पढाइको सिलसिलादेखि पेसागत काम, पारिवारिक जीवन, सामुदायिक जीवन आदि अनेकन सिलसिलामा निर्णयहरू लिनुपर्ने हुन्छ । त्यस्तो निर्णय लिनमा आफूलाई कठिन अनुभव भएमा त्यसले हामीलाई मनोवैज्ञानिक रूपमा केही चाप पर्न सक्छन् र त्यसलाई हलुको पार्न कसैकसैको मद्दत आवश्यक हुन्छ। हामी कुनै पनि निर्णय लिनुपर्दा वा कुनै समस्याको समाधानका उपायको खोजी गर्नुपर्दा कसै न कसैको मद्दतको अपेक्षा गर्ने अवस्थामा पुग्छौं । हो, त्यस्तो अवस्थामा विशेष गरी मनोवैज्ञानिक चाप अनुभव भएका विषयमा पहिलो कुराकानी गर्न सकिने भरपर्दो र अनुकूल परिणाम दिन सक्ने सेवामूलक विधा नै विमर्श वा मनोविमर्श हो ।

स्वास्थ्य र मनोविमर्शको यही आधारभूत बुझाइसाथ विमर्श मनोविज्ञानको औपचारिक रूपले नै ज्ञान र सीप आर्जन गर्ने उद्देश्यले हामीले २०७६ साल चैत्रमा त्रिचन्द्र क्याम्पसमा विमर्श मनोविज्ञान विषयमा स्नातकोत्तर (पोस्टग्राजुएट डिप्लोमा इन काउन्सिलिङ साइकोलोजी) तहमा भर्ना भयौं । भौतिक रूपमा पढाइ सुरु हुँदा नहुँदै कोभिड १९ को महामारी विश्वभरै फैलियो र नेपालमा पनि बन्दाबन्दीका अवस्थाहरू बने । प्रविधिको प्रयोग गर्दै हाम्रा लागि कक्षाहरू अनलाइनमा सञ्चालन भए। परिस्थिति केही खुकुलो भएपछि थोरै भौतिक कक्षा फेरि सञ्चालित भए पनि बीचैमा त्यो पनि रोकिने अवस्था आयो । हामीले सम्पादन गर्नुपर्ने सीपमूलक अध्ययनका अनेक पक्ष त्यसबाट स्वाभाविक रूपमा प्रभावित भए। कतिपय कार्य हामीले अनलाइनबाट सम्पन्न गरे पनि सहज र भौतिक रूपमा गरिनेजस्तै प्रभावकारी नतिजा ल्याउन सकिइन ।

व्यावहारिक ज्ञान र सीप आर्जनकै एक अङ्गको रूपमा स्मारिका प्रकाशन गर्ने पनि कार्यक्रमकै एउटा पाटोको रूपमा लिइने गरेको रहेछ । कोभिड १९ कै कारणले अगिल्लो समूहको स्मारिका प्रकाशन हुन बाँकी नै रहेको रहेछ । एक बर्से कार्यक्रमका स्मारिका प्रकाशनबाहेकका शैक्षिक तथा प्रयोगात्मक कामहरू पूरा गर्ने हामीलाई दुई वर्ष लाग्यो र २०७८ चैतमा मात्र हामीले हाम्रा परीक्षा दिन सक्यौं । हामीले अध्ययन अवधिका बीचमा स्मारिकाका लागि लेखरचना तथा अन्य सामग्रीको लेखन तथा सङ्कलनको काम सकेका थियौं । सम्पादन र प्रकाशनका अन्य काम बाँकी थिए । सुरुमा स्मारिका प्रकाशन कार्यक्रमको अनिवार्य अङ्गकै रूपमा हामीले बुझेको हुनाले त्यसलाई प्रकाशन गर्ने पछि भन्ने हामीलाई अध्ययनअवधिभर लागिर हयो ।

ई । विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्मारिका

अन्त्यतः हामीले हाम्रो एक बर्से कार्यक्रमको दुई वर्षको पढाइका अनुभवलाई सम्झाउने स्मारिका प्रकाशन गरौं भन्ने साझा सोच बनायौं । यो स्मारिका हाम्रो त्यही साझा सोचको साकार रूप हो। यसभित्र हाम्रो सामान्य परिचय र अध्ययन अवधिका अध्ययन र अन्य अनुभूतिजन्य सिर्जित हाम्रा केही रचनाहरू छन् । कतिपय रचना मनोविज्ञान र विमर्श मनोविज्ञानको ज्ञानसँगै जोडिएका छन् भने केही मौलिक साहित्यिक/कलात्मक सिर्जना छन् । यो स्मारिकाले हामी २०७७ समूहका विद्यार्थीलाई जीवनको महत्वपूर्ण र पेचिलो अवधि र परिवेशको सम्झना गराइरहनेछ भन्ने हामीले ठानेका छौं । समूहभन्दा बाहिरका पाठकका लागि पनि विमर्श मनोविज्ञानका केही पाटाहरूको ज्ञान उजिल्याउन सहयोगी हुनेछ भन्ने हाम्रो विश्वास छ ।

यो प्रकाशनमा आइपुग्ने गरी हामीलाई हामीलाई मनोविज्ञान र विमर्श मनोविज्ञानका विभिन्न विषय र पक्षमा हामीलाई ज्ञान र मार्गप्रदर्शन गर्ने सर्वश्री डा. भारती अधिकारी, डा. नारायण शर्मा, डा. गोविन्दशरण उपाध्याय, डा. सुरज शाक्य, प्रभाषकुमार राउत, राजन केसी, पद्मप्रसाद घिमिरे, गणेश आमगाउँ, आशीष काफ्ले र सागर नेपाललगायत गुरुजनमा हार्दिक आभारसहित कृतज्ञता प्रकट गर्दछौं। यस्तै हाम्रो अध्ययन अवधिको प्रयोगात्मक विषय, क्षेत्रकार्य (फिल्डवर्क) तथा सामुदायिक भ्रमण (कम्युनिटी भिजिट) लगायतका काममा हामीलाई विविध हिसाबले सहयोग गर्ने पीजीडीपी कार्यक्रमका हिमा भण्डारी र कल्पना पौडेलको सहयोगप्रति हामी कृतज्ञ छौं र हार्दिक कृतज्ञता ज्ञापन गर्दछौं ।

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Meet your soul

- Bandana Neupane

You never know what will be the next,
Where does life end?
No never knows the life
Oh life ! you are unexpectedly unpredictable.
Thinking tomorrow is itself a dreaming,
Today, a reality, stay healthy and happy
The steering of the journey may be pulled!

Meet your own soul to know what you are and who you are,
Only you know yourself, no else better knows that you face.
Do not panic yourself but search for reasons behind,
Difficulties may hit you hard and you may not see any chance to come out,
You may feel to leave life and hold it in peace.

Be aware of being a hunter of yourself
Others may become murderer of their own life committing suicide;
They find their doors and windows of life are closed,
Cowardly they choose the wrong steps; and
They fail meeting their own souls.
Soul means knowing your own self, the best medication;
Where you yourself find the solutions of healing.

Ups and downs are part of life,
The hope is there to tie you up;
Hope of doing something new is your deal with the life,
The positive weave that you create to meet your soul,
Failure and success are just passer by which makes us engage in your life.

People around you may console you but may not heal you,
Your soul is your driver, operator and regulator,
You may take advice and suggestions from others
But you take your own decision, the soul is the decision maker.

You may learn from others but may not be taught by them
When you lose your hopes, you can ask someone to listen to you and
ask for support but you should lie to your soul that is your own life;
Because your soul is there to teach yourself,
Really, you are sovereign because you have a soul, a symbol of sovereignty.

Twenty-Twenty

- Kanchan Rai

The year 2020 was the year that laughed at everyone's expectations that there would be something special like the name. In the midst of life, the blurry words, thoughts and imagination that grew inside of the head took place. The biggest pandemic shook life around the world. Yesterday, I was sitting on a chair in the room that looks the same every time. Really, a world was without a beautiful morning light and even the summer, spring, falls and winter were all gone with good memories.

I thought 2020 would be a decent year of doing everything we could with joy and confidence along with all the resolutions we made. A lot of dust like me had to escape from the reality of fear and we forgot about the dream we had. No wonder, everything was not right. Many people lost their job where many people changed the job, schooling stopped where technology ruled over, market price went up, hunger increased, many young lives committed suicide where many spent their days at hospital, and many more.

Whoever is reading this, you have already won the biggest battle in your life. Again, another year has come for all you dreamers. I do not want you to be disappointed, but I don't want you to expect it, but I don't want you to hold something in grief. Be free from all those chains of regrets, discover more yourself, love yourself, do the stuff that makes you happy but "do not let others' opinion be your reality". Once again engraved the fact that many people love and care for you and are waiting to see your beautiful life.

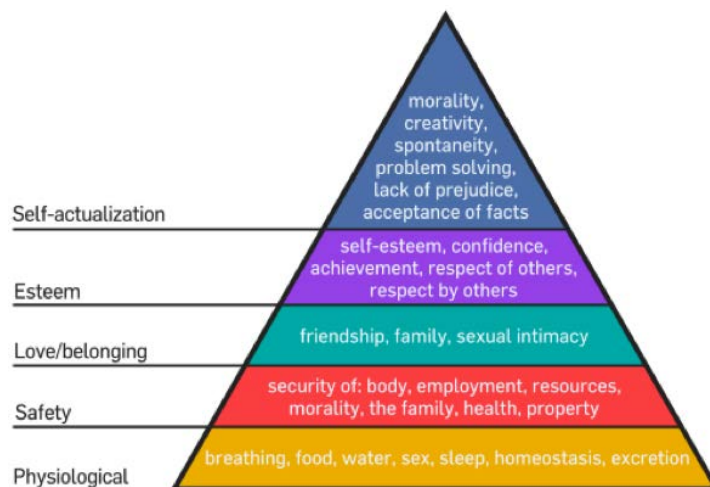
With this year, let us all write down a little bit short and calmly that this year was not in vain. We don't know yet but surely we have not taught us a lot of things and I hope it does not take a long time to realize it. The important things that matters in our life is; did we learn something form that incident? Are we now stronger enough to cope with such rough times? Are we now mentally and emotionally strong enough to face it? If we have answers for this, then trust me you have a better life waiting for you dearly.

Odd Ramblings on Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs and Asexuality

- Dr. Manita Newa

Why a person does something and may not remain idol al the times? This fundamental question may lead us to think about the factors that push us to do something, that drive us to a particular behavior to behave and so on. Search of force or the factor that initiates, guides, and maintains behavior directed to achieve something might have a long history in human civilizations.

The biological, emotional, social, and cognitive forces to activate behavior is known as motivation. In 1943 a renowned psychologist A. H. Maslow proposed ' A theory of human motivation' which has been applauded and debated by many in the last half of a century. Maslow's hierarchy of needs now is a common integration in modern day culture popping up in the meme sphere as well portrayed with stratification of needs as they level up from fundamental needs at the base and need for self-transcendence at the top of a pyramid.



The assumptions that Maslow bases human motivation on and the hierarchy are as follows:-

- Human behavior is influenced by needs and only unsatisfied needs act as motivators.

- Human needs in order of importance range from basic physiological needs to complex needs of self transcendence.
 - Fulfillment of lower level needs in a reasonably satisfied degree unlock higher level needs.
- 1) Physiological needs: - These are the physical needs for human survival. If they aren't met, human body is said to not function properly and eventually fail. They are Hunger, Thirst, Shelter, Sex and other bodily needs.
 - 2) Safety needs: - Once physiological needs are relatively satisfied safety needs are said to take precedence and dominate behavior. It includes Personal security from physical and emotional harm, financial security and absence of illness or accident or their adverse impacts.
 - 3) Social belonging needs: - It focuses on a sense of belonging and acceptance among social groups namely affection, acceptance and friendship.
 - 4) Esteem needs: - Internal and external factors that determine being accepted and valued fall under this need. Self-respect, Achievement, Autonomy, Status, attention and recognition fulfill esteem needs.
 - 5) Self-actualization:-actualization: - This level is said to be reached only once all aforementioned needs have not just been achieved but mastered (Maslow 1954). It is a drive to achieve ones highest form of being in terms of growth and reaching one's full potential and self-fulfillment
 - 6) Self transcendence: - It refers to the highest and most holistic level of human consciousness in relation to oneself and the whole universe along with the nature and beings within the cosmos.

These being the mainstay of Maslow's theory it is fair to note that despite its popularity it fares its share of criticism not just from hundreds of self determination theory researchers but from thousands of studies that imply the universal physiological needs as Autonomy, Relatedness and Competence. (Fowler 2014). It has been noted that there is lack of support that a hierarchy even exists (Lawyer and Suttle 1972). It has been pointed out that it fails to display the differences in needs of those raised in individualistic societies as opposed to collectivist society (Cianci and Gambrel 2003) and doesn't't take into account the cross-cultural disparities and age and individual differences as well (Goebel and Brown 1981). It has even been noted that higher and lower order of needs aren't universal. (Tang and West 1997).

My ramblings however start here at how it ranks sex as a basic physiological need indispensable along with food and breathing. Not only does it neglect the emotional, familial and evolutionary aspects by placing it in basic needs but it also doesn't keep in context the people who do not experience sexual attraction (asexual) and who do not see sex as a need for life fulfillment that they need to move past to achieve other higher stages of motivation. (Bogaert 2006).

Giving sex the position at basic needs also possess an ethical corollary as it would promote rape culture. By this logic we would be violating someone's human rights if we decline to have sex with them. If we go into further depth keeping sex as a foundational need then does that mean that this alleged "right" to obtain sex a more basic need than the "right to be not raped"? Or does "Safety/security of body"; the "right to be not raped" have higher priority than fulfilling everyone's alleged "need" for sex? Not consenting to sex would be argued as denying a basic human need and thus attempt to justify rape which is not just plain unjust but would question the whole notion of human beings being a higher being with consciousness and morality unlike animals from a lower cerebral strata some lower cerebral strata.

While eastern society is baseline sex negative with stigma around sex for non-reproductive purposes it has not placed sex alongside food, water, air and sleep which are practically essential human needs. With celibacy being celebrated and purity culture rampant in the east it might be argued that the east is sex hating but the reality is far from it. Old scriptures, Vedas and archeological sites prove that it was seen as a natural part of life. The Upanishads place sexual intercourse into three themes, one as a Dhama/ duty for the human race, the other as Kama / pleasure and lastly for moksha / liberation. It however wasn't a notion forced compulsorily as something that makes human beings human. Bramhachari or being celibate though very different from asexuality did provide a space for a life not revolving around sex and in a religious setting was seen in a good light. Celibacy is a choice where an individual abstains from sex due to various reasons but is attracted sexually towards people whereas asexual do not feel sexual attraction or feel very little or infrequently and in a low intensity and might even be sex favorable for various reasons and its more about the attraction and not the action. When we compare this to the western ideologies that force us compulsory sexuality just like compulsory homogeneity and heteronormativity the differences in acceptance of diversity among the eastern and western world becomes evident.

Scientifically speaking "sexual health" is dynamic, fluid and ever changing posing a difficulty to define it without pathologizing and calling minority sexual practices

and orientations as problematic sexual behavior even when ethically and naturally they may be nothing but non normative and healthy expressions of human sexuality: homosexuality, bisexuality, BDSM, polyamory, asexuality. And while sexual desire and interest naturally fits into the definition of sexual health, the absence of so should be normalized as well.

One might argue that Maslow's hierarchy of needs is beyond one individual's personal needs and it is more about the collective survival and procreation of the species but how fair is it to place it on a pedestal with all physiologically indispensable needs and to say that a human being who has not got those needs fulfilled do not reach the tiers above those and would not be; according to this theory able to reach for needs for safety, love, esteem and self-actualization all the while millions of asexual are living on in their lives without sexual attraction and need to copulate? How fair is it to call sex a human need when a large chunk of "humans" don't feel it to be necessary to have a happy and fulfilling life? How fair is it to dehumanize them and invalidate their lived experiences? How fair is it?

This is my cue to end this ramble with nothing but unanswered and indefinite conclusions about asexual lives and Maslow's hierarchy of needs but with a different point of view from a different lived experience and question for all the readers. Theories that are idolized and revered have the duty to represent the entirety of the diverse human population and those who uphold these have a duty to be up to date and grow our concepts keeping in mind the fallacies and limitations of these attempts to encompass the human psyche.

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SOCIETY'S VIEWS TOWARDS MENTAL ILLNESS

- Nisha Adhikari

In Nepali, a wizard is known as Bokso and a witch is called Bokshi. Both of these are considered to be an evil spiritual power possessing persons and they may suffer others by looking or putting their sights upon the things that they wish to have. On the other hand, an occultist is known as Tantrika. All these people are believed capable of playing with evil power. Some people who claim themselves as Matas (mothers), Devatas or Dhami operate their business in the name of traditional healers. Tantra Mantra is called witchcraft. From rural areas to large and progressive cities, necromancers claim as healers in their own ethnic names as Dhami Guru, Mata, Jhakri, Janappa, Bijuwa etc. As folklore, mental problems are believed as the sufferings caused by the evil or dissatisfied spirits as supernatural power are widespread across Nepal.

Every caste and tribe is dominated by witches, ghosts and phantoms. Such people appear in society under different names. Kathmandu has become a metropolis with a population of millions. Apart from Khak or Kichkandi, there are many things or superstitions in the capital that have disappeared from society due to religion and culture. Banjakri, Jhankri, Devta, Devi etc. are running their business in small areas as well as in the center of the city. Such anti-superstition laws should be strictly enforced and only by protecting the society by changing the way of thinking.

Even in developed countries, little research has been done on various brain activities. In Nepal, only general treatment of mental illness has been started and most of the projects have not been made according to the working method of the brain. In any case, some Nepalese have made Nepal their field of work. In conducting research from foreign universities, it is necessary to take more time to accurately identify and analyze the mental state of Nepalese and the differences between the two.

It is projected that science only knows about the simple and one-third function of the mind. It is not possible to treat mental illnesses such as bone marrow transplants or cancerous cells. By including young children in textbooks, witchcraft will be easier to eradicate. Fear of witchcraft, ghosts, etc. should be the result we tell from childhood to adulthood. We think of such unbalanced behavior in people

when there is great mental pressure or any other reason behind building a house with such an idea in our mind.

The society strongly believed, many unmarried or single women, young men and women who have betrayed love and widows seem to have demons and witches in them. It seems that such a person can be cured by timely psychological counseling. But for those who have been suffering from such stress for a long time, it is appropriate to arrange for medical treatment under the supervision of a psychiatrist. In such cases, the witch-hunter gradually disappears.

By making time for treatment, the mentality of the person coming for psychotherapy will gradually increase. The habit of blaming different types of people also goes away. Even today, many people are reluctant to tell anyone about their illness because they view mental illness or depression in a negative light. Such people are still considered psychic in society. Let's say that mental illness can be cured through counseling and can be easily treated by a psychiatrist and psychologist, just like as normal as the treatment of other diseases.

Gender Discrimination in Workplace

- Charu Aryal

Gender discrimination can be understood as treating someone unfavorably, disproportionately, indecently or discriminately on any ground because of the person's sex or gender. This may happen in the workplaces whether they are applying for a job or are placed as employed. Gender discrimination, although predominantly an issue for women, can sometimes be directed towards men as well. There are four main types of gender discrimination:

- 1. Direct discrimination:** This happens when, because of your gender/sex, someone treats you worse than someone of the opposite gender/sex who is in a similar situation. Pregnancy and maternity: It would be unlawful for an employer to manage and monitor absences from work due to morning sickness and count these towards triggers for action under their attendance management protocol. Unequal pay among men and women of the same calibre and qualifications for the same job responsibilities is an issue worldwide.
- 2. Indirect discrimination:** Indirect discrimination happens when an organization has a particular policy or way of working that applies in the same way to both genders but which puts you at a disadvantage because of your gender/sex. For example: an employer decides to change shift patterns for staff so that they finish at 7 pm instead of 5 pm. Female employees with caring responsibilities could be at a disadvantage if the new shift pattern means they cannot give time for childcare.

Indirect gender discrimination can be permitted if the organization or employer is able to show that there is a good reason for the policy.

- 3. Harassment:** There are three types of harassment relating to sex/gender.

Type 1	The first type is when someone makes you feel humiliated, offended or degraded because of gender/sexual bias.
Example 1	A male manager makes comments that there is no point promoting women because they go off to have children. Even though he doesn't direct these comments at a particular female employee, one of his staff is very upset by this and worries about her career. This could be considered harassment.

Type 2	The second type of harassment is called sexual harassment. This is when someone makes you feel humiliated, offended or degraded because they treat you in a sexual way. This is known as 'unwanted conduct of a sexual nature' and covers verbal and physical treatment, like sexual comments or jokes, touching, or assault. It also covers sending emails / texts of a sexual nature or posting sexual / pornographic content to or about someone on social media.
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Example 2	A male manager makes sexual jokes to one of his female subordinates and implies that she will get a raise or promotion if she sleeps with him.
Type 3	The third type of harassment is when someone treats you unfairly because you refused to put up with sexual harassment.
Example 3	A male manager invites one of his female employees home after they have been out for a drink. She declines. A couple of weeks later she is turned down for a promotion. She believes this is because she turned down her boss's proposition.

4. **Victimization:** This is when you are treated badly because you have made a complaint of sex related discrimination. It can also occur if you are supporting someone who has made a complaint of such discrimination. For example: a male colleague is helping a female co-worker with her claim of sex related discrimination. The male colleague is then sacked or treated badly by his employer.

Myths vs. Realities

There are many myths regarding the common understanding of sexual harassment, some of which are listed below along with their corresponding realities. Myths related to sexual harassment are based on the existing attitudes and stereotypes about sex, sexuality and other compounding factors like age, race, sexual orientation and disability. Myths about sexual harassment fail to accept the harmful effect and nature of its conduct. They shift the blame from the perpetrator to the victim and obscure the motivation of the harasser which is mainly to gain power and control over the victim or the person harassed.

Myth : Sexual harassment is just a way of expressing sexual desire.

Reality : Sexual harassment is a way of expressing hostile and aggressive behavior. It is the abuse of power through sexual behavior as the vehicle and it is against the law.

Myth : It's not a big deal if a person is harassed; it's done with the motive of "good fun."

Reality : Sexual harassment is abusive. It is not done in jest or "good fun"; but it is done to intimidate and hurt other people. Everyone has a right to professional treatment, with respect, consideration and decent behavior.

Myth : There is a profile of a typical harasser.

Reality : Harassers are found in all types of occupations, at all organizational levels, among businesses, academic and all ethnic and religious groups. Those who sexually harass are indistinguishable from their colleagues who do not harass in terms of gender, age, marital status, rank, job title, occupation or nationality.

Myth : Men can't help themselves when they are aroused sexually.

Reality : Men are responsible for and capable of controlling their behavior and acting professionally in workplaces and educational institutions, just as women are.

Myth : If you ignore sexual harassment, it will stop.

Reality : Generally, ignoring sexual harassment simply won't stop it. Ignoring such behavior may be taken by the harasser as a sign of encouragement or tacit consent. Many victims have reported that when they directly tell the harasser to stop, the harassment often, but not always, ends.

Myth : Some people just interact in a physical way and are accustomed to touching others, nothing is meant by this.

Reality : Family and social interactions differ from individual to individual, community to community, and ethnic and racial group to ethnic and racial group. However, unwanted and unwelcome physical gestures such as hugging, pinching, or brushing up against a person's body may be forms of sexual harassment.

Myth : People who dress in a sexually attractive manner are asking for sexual comments.

Reality : The harasser is always responsible for having committed the harassment regardless of an individual's appearance, behavior, judgement, or previous actions. Professional dress codes, if they exist, should be enforced for both sexes.

Myth : Only men can sexually harass women.

Reality : Both men and women may be targets or perpetrators of sexual harassment. Many times men may not realize that they are sexually harassed because society has unwritten rules that men are supposed to enjoy conversations, attention or behaviors of a sexual nature. As such, it may be difficult for an individual man to recognize his discomfort in these situations or to vocalize this discomfort. Also, women can harass other women and men can harass other men. Sexual harassment is the unwelcome sexual behavior or attention regardless of who is perpetrating, or who is the target of the behavior.

Myth : There is nothing that can be done about sexual harassment.

Reality : On the contrary, there are many steps that can be taken to prevent sexual harassment, and to respond appropriately when/if it does occur. Strong policies and effective procedures articulated by the head of an organization or institution that are communicated to and understood by all employees are critical for prevention of sexual harassment.

Every employee/employer should be aware that a person should not be discriminated against because of any of the following:

- someone is (or is not) belonging to a particular sex/gender
- someone thinks you are the opposite sex/gender; appearance of belonging to a particular sex/gender (discrimination by perception)
- someone is being connected or acquainted to someone of a particular gender/sex (discrimination by association)
- someone does not conform to the defined “male/female”

According to the Constitution of Nepal 2015, Ministry of law, justice and parliamentary affairs is the governing body that makes sure that the rights of women are ensured in the following manner:

- Every woman shall have equal lineage right without gender based discrimination.
- Every woman shall have the right to safe motherhood and reproductive health.
- No woman shall be subjected to physical, mental, sexual, psychological or other form of violence or exploitation on grounds of religion, social, cultural tradition, practice or on any other grounds.
- Such acts shall be punishable by law, and the victim shall have the right to obtain compensation in accordance with law.

Gender/sexual harassment towards minority communities like differently abled (more commonly labelled as disabled) and LGBTQIA+ is more common in our society and equally punishable as in the case of other communities. Even though gender/sexual harassment at workplace is not explicitly mentioned in the law of our country, it is undeniable that discrimination according to gender identity for transgender or disabled people is unlawful. There are more instances of gender discrimination and sexual harassment among these group of people and their voices should be equally heard.

What to do if someone feels that s/he is sexually discriminated against or harassed?

1. The first step should be to start by telling the person involved to stop the behavior. The victim should try to be as specific as possible. For example, "It makes me uncomfortable when you leer (look or gaze in a lascivious or unpleasant way) at me, please do not do this."
2. If this does not work, it should be considered to put it in writing, and tell the person what conduct was offensive and what action will be taken if it continues. For instance, "I find your sexual jokes offensive. I consider these to be sexual harassment and I will file a complaint if you continue to tell them to me."
3. If none of the above works, the victim should reach out to his/her supervisor (unless he or she is the offender her/him-self) or a human resource person of the organization (i.e., a complaint should be filed).

Gaslighting: An emotional abuse in relationship

- Melina Bhattarai

Jason's lover, Mark, is extremely jealous. "He has to know where I am twenty-four hours a day," Jason complained. "He calls me at work several times a day, and if I'm away from my desk, he gets really angry and wants to know where I was and what I was doing. There are several nice-looking men in my office, and Mark is convinced I'm going to have an affair with one of them. It does absolutely no good at all for me to try to reassure him. And he's constantly accusing me of flirting. **The worst part about it is that I'm beginning to question myself. I don't think I flirt, but maybe I do without realizing it.**"

Brian noticed Sarah had been coming home from work later than usual in the past month. She used to come home at seven p.m., but now she regularly arrived home at nine, with not so much as a returned phone call or text. Brian waited another month before he asked Sarah what was going on at work. He even asked her point blank whether she was having an affair. He would have asked her earlier, but he was afraid she would become icy cold and shut him out, as she had done several times during their marriage. When asked, Sarah responded coolly that she wasn't sure what Brian was talking about, that she had always gotten home from work at the same time. She then said that she had been concerned about John's state of mind lately, and wondered whether he was the one having an affair.

Brian never brought up the late nights to Sarah again, although he thought about it constantly. **He even convinced himself that Sarah might have been right. Maybe she had always come home at that time.** However, one night he caught Sarah in an intimate phone call. When confronted, she denied having an affair. Brian finally learned the truth when 25 the wife of one of Sarah's coworkers contacted him. It turns out that Sarah and this woman's husband had been having an affair for at least six months. As Sarah left the home for good, her parting words to Brian were, "If you were a better husband, I wouldn't have had to seek companionship elsewhere." Brian wondered why he hadn't just "cut and run" when he was first dating Sarah and she admitted she was living with her boyfriend.

When Josie met Jamie, it was love at first sight. Jamie showered Josie with gifts and trips, telling her, "I've never felt this way about anyone." Jamie talked with Josie about marriage and kids within their first week of dating. She wound up spending

all her time with him, and eventually stopped seeing her other friends. Jamie said they were “bad influences” on Josie and constantly reminded her that she was happier when she wasn’t around them. After a few months of “bliss,” Josie started experiencing Jamie would completely ignore her, without Josie knowing what she had done to upset him. She would wreck her brain trying to figure it out. Jamie wouldn’t return calls, “which made me worried and made me contact him more.”

Josie’s sister told her she needed to stop contacting Jamie and wait for him to contact her. “It was one of the hardest things for me to do, because I still didn’t know what I did wrong.” Josie now spent her time waiting for Jamie to call and scouring the Internet for articles on what to do when your partner ignores you. Two weeks later, she got a text from Jamie. It said, “Your bike is here.” Josie said her heart raced and she got butterflies in her stomach. She answered his text right away. “Are you okay? Where are you?” This was met with more silence. After some heavy crying, she texted, “I can’t do this. I just don’t understand anymore.”

A few hours later, she got a knock on her door. It was Jamie, with her bike—and flowers. “He told me that we needed to go bike riding together, like, right now. I felt really uncomfortable about it, but I went anyway.” During the bike ride, Jamie didn’t mention anything about his disappearing or lack of communication—instead, he talked about moving in together. “It was like nothing had happened at all. I chalked it up to him just needing some space.” About two months after they reconciled, Jamie started the silent treatment again—and it went off and on like this for two years.

The times in between the stonewalling became “worse and worse. We stopped having what I called ‘honeymoon’ periods.” Jamie went from asking her to move in with him to saying he had changed his mind “because I was unstable. He kept me hanging in there with his promises that we would take things to the next level. Then it would fall apart again.” Josie said of Jamie, “Looking back, Jamie looked great on paper—smart, educated, funny. ... but now that I really look at it, there were some red flags from the beginning. He had cut off contact with his brother and sister several years prior, and he was always blaming people at work for why he never got a promotion. He also criticized me more and more over time, especially for 27 things I couldn’t change—like my family.”

Although Jason, Brian and Josie don’t realize it, they are all being gaslighted. The same is true of thousands of other women and men like them. Slowly, systematically, their self-confidence is whittled away, their self-esteem is eroded, and their perception of themselves is distorted—and yet they don’t even know it is happening.

What's gaslighting?

Gaslighters are master controllers and manipulators, often challenging your very sense of reality. And they can be found everywhere. International political figures, celebrities, your boss, your sibling or parent, a friend, your coworker, your neighbor, your partner—any one of these people is in a position to gaslight. She's the woman on your team who always manages to take credit for your good work. He's the politician who can never admit to a mistake, the harasser who says you asked for it.

The Origin of the Term “gaslighting”

The term seems to have been coined by Patrick Hamilton in his 1938 play *Gas Light*, and first made popular by the 1944 movie *Gaslight*, directed by George Cukor and starring Ingrid Bergman and Charles Boyer. Gregory, Paula's husband, tries to convince her that she is going crazy—losing objects precious to her, hearing and seeing things that aren't there, thinking the lights are flickering when he claims they are not. It turns out it has all been a setup to “gaslight” her. Though the term *gaslight*, as a kind of psychological manipulation, was first added to the Oxford English Dictionary in December 2004, although the documented use of this word and its variants goes back to 1952 (Yagoda, B. 2017).

Portrait of gaslighter, Knowing gaslighter

Gaslighters will only apologize if they are trying to get something out of you. Even if they do give you an apology, if you listen carefully, you'll see that it's really a nonapology, and they'll usually only give it because you asked for one or because they were forced by a judge or mediator to do so. You know, when someone says, “I'm sorry you feel that way.” That's not an apology.

They Habitually Lie

If gaslighters are caught with the proverbial “hand in the cookie jar,” they will look you right in the eye and tell you they did no such thing. It makes you question your sanity—Maybe I didn't see them do that after all. This is what they want—for you to become more dependent on their version of reality. They may even push things further along by telling you that you are losing your mind. What gaslighters say is virtually meaningless; they are habitual liars. For this reason, you always want to pay attention to what gaslighters do, not what they say.

They Use “Flying Monkeys”

Gaslighters will try to send messages to you through other people—especially when you take the courageous step to cut off contact. These people are sometimes unwittingly carrying a gaslighter’s messages.

They Use Triangulation and Splitting

Because driving a wedge between you and other people serves their need to dominate and control. Gaslighters know that splitting and triangulation will draw you closer to them—and distance you from the person they are pitting you against.

They Use Blatant Attempts to Curry Favor

Gaslighters are also masters at buttering people up. They will use false flattery to get what they want from you. As soon as you fulfill their needs, they’ll drop their mask of niceness. Trust your gut. If the friendliness seems forced or phony, beware.

They Expect Special Treatment

Gaslighters feel that standard societal rules, such as politeness, respect, and patience, don’t apply to them—they are above these rules. For example, a gaslighter will expect his partner to be home precisely at a certain time and have dinner on the table when he gets home. If the partner doesn’t fulfill this obligation, the gaslighter becomes irrationally angry and retaliates. They Mistreat People Who Have Less Power You can tell a lot about people by how they treat a person who has less power than they do. For example, look at how someone treats wait staff at a restaurant. Does she bark her order at the server, or does she order politely? What happens when a dish comes out and it is not what the diner requested? Does she assertively but politely ask for a correction, or does she make a scene and yell at the server? Demeaning the server can be a symptom of gaslighting.

They Use Your Weaknesses Against You

Many times, you’ll begin a relationship with a gaslighter feeling very safe, so you do what any trusting human in what she thinks is a healthy relationship would do—you share your intimate thoughts and feelings with the person. This is normal, natural, a healthy part of developing a close relationship. However, notice that the gaslighter rarely reveals as much intimate information about himself. Meanwhile, the information you share will soon be getting used against you in fights—it becomes psychological ammunition. For instance, a confidence you shared with the gaslighter about your conflicted relationship with your sister is now thrown back

at you as, “No wonder we are arguing. Your sister can’t stand you, either. You treat her the same way you treat me.”

They Compare You to Others

Gaslighters also use comparison as a way of driving a wedge between people, thus gaining control. Parents who gaslight frequently compare their children to each other—and in unrealistic and blatant ways. The gaslighting parent usually has a “golden child” and a “scapegoat child.” The former can do no wrong, whereas the latter can do no right. This pits siblings against each other, and these feelings of competition commonly extend into adulthood. Your boss may say, “Why can’t you produce like Jane? She comes in at eight every morning. If she can do it, so can you.” You may always be on the losing end of a comparison, except if it is to denigrate your “competition.” That is, gaslighters may sing your praises to others if their goal is to make those others look bad. Perfection is unattainable, no matter how hard you try to meet the gaslighter’s unreasonable expectations.

They Are Obsessed with Their Accomplishments

Gaslighters often will boast about the things they have accomplished, such as how they got an employee-of-the-month award at work. Never mind that it was fifteen years ago! They will badger you when you don’t react with enthusiasm and praise when they tell you once again about the time that they “dropped the mic” on someone. Gaslighters put an extreme amount of importance on their own accomplishments, however delusional these accomplishments and attributes may be.

They Prefer to Associate with People Who Fawn Over Them

Friends who would confront gaslighters about their behavior have no place in the gaslighters’ life. Gaslighters will associate only with people who put them up on a pedestal, the way they feel they deserve to be treated. The second gaslighters feel that you no longer admire and cater to them, they will drop you.

They Put You in a Double Bind

Double binds are situations in which you are forced to choose between two undesirable options, or you are given conflicting messages. For instance, your gaslighting spouse tells you that you need to lose weight, then serves various desserts that night at dinner. You are in a no-win situation. Gaslighters like to place people in emotional dilemmas—your uncertainty is a sign to them that they have control over you.

They Are Obsessed with Their Image

How dare you make gaslighters look bad! They will pay you back. Gaslighters are obsessed with how they look to others. They tend to spend a large amount of money on grooming products and a lot of time looking at themselves in the mirror. They may get upset when you touch their hair or use one of their grooming products. Perfection is their goal—and it is impossible to obtain. Some gaslighters will even forgo necessities to pay for cosmetic surgery and other appearance enhancing procedures.

They Are Obsessed with Your Image

Not only can gaslighters be overly obsessed with how they look, they can also be very particular about how you look. Body weight tends to especially be a target for gaslighters. They will ridicule their partners about their weight and clothing choices. Gaslighters will buy outfits for their partners that they deem acceptable. The underlying message: you are not good enough.

They Con People

Everything is a game to gaslighters—and conning is an essential part of the game. Gaslighters want to see how much they can swindle you, emotionally or financially. Gaslighters are also not as smart as they think—they will openly brag about their cons. This is one thing that often leads to their downfall.

They Cause Fear in Others

Family and friends of a gaslighter may defend the gaslighter against people that have the audacity to call him out on his behavior, or may themselves avoid confronting the gaslighter. This occurs for two main reasons:

- (1) The friends and family have become accustomed to the gaslighter's behavior and consider it to be normal; and
- (2) They are protecting themselves from looking disloyal to the gaslighter. This is especially common in the children of gaslighters.

They Have a Bad Temper

Gun violence is a concern with gaslighters due to their hot tempers. In the United States, 8.9 percent of the population have both impulsive angry behavior and own firearms (Swanson et al. 2015). Gaslighters at first will try to quietly display this anger, as to keep up their facade of perfection. However, they can only keep up this

fake display for so long. The first time you see the gaslighter drop that mask, it can be quite startling.

Punishment Doesn't Affect Them

The punishment and rewards tend to have less of an effect, which results in gaslighters' being more likely to "do their own thing" without concern about reactions from others.

They Practice "Cognitive Empathy"

Gaslighters may seem to understand how you feel, but looking closer, their reactions seem flat or prerecorded—there is no real emotion behind their words. Gaslighters are experts at using "cognitive empathy"—acting as if they have empathy without actually feeling it.

They Refuse Personal Responsibility

They feel that they are normal and everyone else is crazy. It is always someone else's fault. This is the gaslighters' mantra. They are so difficult to treat—they don't think anything is wrong with them or their behavior.

They Wear You Down over Time

Gaslighters bank on the idea that, with enough time, they can weaken your spirit. They also expect that if they gradually ramp up their manipulative behavior, you will be the proverbial frog in the frying pan. And so, they will increase the heat so slowly that you don't realize you're being psychologically burned alive. In the beginning of your relationship with a gaslighter, things may be pretty good—in fact, they are too good to be true. The gaslighter still even compliments you from time to time. Then, the criticisms creep in. The reason for this flip-flop between contempt and praise? Gaslighters know confusion weakens the psyche. With uncertainty comes vulnerability. Toward the end, you are believing blatant lies that you never would have accepted at the beginning of your relationship.

They Are Terrible Teasers

At first, it's small things said when the two of you are alone, such as how your hair looks, or your accent. It then ramps up to their teasing you in front of your friends. When you say that their comments or mimicry bothers you, they tell you that you are being too sensitive.

This is different than just regular sibling teasing or joking around with friends. With gaslighters, it is a perpetual teasing, it has a mean quality to it, and most important, your requests for it to stop go unheeded.

They Project Their Emotions

Gaslighters may have such a poor sense of their own emotions or actions that they have no idea they are projecting their behavior onto someone else. For example, a gaslighter will say you need a drug test, when he, himself, is the one who is using it.

They Isolate You

Gaslighters tend to tell you that your friends and family are bad influences on you, or that you don't seem happy when you are around those you actually care about. They may also refuse to go to family events with you because "Your family makes me uncomfortable" or some other vague, substance-less excuse. The more the gaslighter succeeds at isolating you, the more susceptible you are to his control.

They Tell Others That You Are Crazy

Gaslighters will drive wedges between you and other people in all sorts of clever ways. There is no more effective way to discredit you than to tell people that you are crazy. You are now seen as fragile and unstable.

They Don't Keep Promises

For gaslighters, promises are made to be broken. If gaslighters promise you anything, assume that it is an empty promise. If a gaslighter happens to be your employer, get those promises in writing.

Loyalty Is Required—But Not Reciprocal

Gaslighters require complete and unrealistic loyalty—but don't expect loyalty from them. whatever they want to you, but God help you if they think you've betrayed them. They will make your life a living hell.

They Kick People When They Are Down

They get a sick pleasure from watching others suffer. They especially get excited when they know someone is suffering because of them.

They Avoid Admitting Problems They've Caused

Gaslighters will say that you, or people around them, are irrational and have things all wrong, when in reality they are avoiding having to explain themselves or take responsibility for their actions.

They Bait and Switch

The gaslighters bring people in by promising them one thing, then switch it on them once they accept it.

Getting Help or Approaching a friend who you think may be in with gaslighters

Pointing out gaslighting when someone isn't ready to acknowledge the relationship's nature can cause them to pull away from you and not talk to you about their relationship. Acknowledging the relationship with a gaslighter is hard. We can help them acknowledge how they feel and support them in realizing that the relationship is an emotionally abusive one, all being patient. You don't want your friend to feel judged or unsupported for being in an abusive relationship. Being a good friend means giving them space to process what's happening, and providing guidance during times of struggle.

Recognizing that you're a victim in your relationship is the important first step toward getting help. The next step involves blocking the gaslighter from every means. Encourage victims (or You if you are a victim) to reach out for help and support from mental health professionals for their own healing.

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Mind, Brain and Computer: Problems for the Computational View of the Mind

- Romisha Thapa

Recently, the BBC featured an article on computer's intelligence. "The computers we have built are now capable of thinking for themselves, and doing complex jobs without our supervision". This statement expresses a widely held-opinion. Not only this but also many scholars often talk about the mind using the metaphor of a computer. Before stating the problems for the computational view of the mind let's take a tour on the different schools of thoughts regarding the mind that we all believe that we have.

One way to find out more about the particular property is to look at something that doesn't have that property. For example, dogs think about food, warmth, shelter, get attention and belly rub. Humans are very similar to the dog in some respects but quite different. Human minds can think about things, plans for the future and have conscious awareness that we can give names as rational calculus beyond general animalistic calculus as tenacity and intuition.

Rene Descartes was famous for putting forward a particular view of how the mind works. He believed that "There's a physical substance that our body made out of. But then, there's a fundamentally different substance which was immaterial". On the other hand, physicalism claims that a human being is a completely physical substance; dualism, however, maintains that a human being is both physical substance and mental substance.

It's important to know the nature of the substance to know the nature of mind. The substance is an entity like an atom or dog. It has several characters. Substances are particular, individual things. They are a continuant, are basic, fundamental and have properties. Some examples of properties are painfulness and redness. According to physicalism, there is only a physical substance which means C-fibers are certain types of neurons that innervate the skin and carries pain impulses. They believe that conscious mental life of emotion, thought and pain are merely physical events.

Dualists disagree with physicalists. They say "part of the very essence of pain is the felt quality it has. Also, propositional attitudes of the mind give meaning to the event. So, the substance dualism holds that mind and brain are two distinct substances: Brains has physical properties and mind has mental properties.

After giving the overview of whether thoughts, painfulness and awareness are merely physical properties or both mental and physical properties. There is a whole new notion about the computers being “intelligent or have a mentality” as human beings. Alan Turing proposed a thought experiment. He says, “Imagine that you’re in a room with a barrier and behind it is a human and a computer. You don’t know which one is which. Your task is to work out which one is human and the computer just from the answer you get from the question”. After this, according to him, “When we get to the point that we cannot decide which is human or which is the machine, there we have managed to build a machine that is capable of mentality, a machine that can think”.

The question remains, how good is the Turing test for testing whether a computer can think? First of all, it's language-based, so all the testing is for an intelligence that can communicate via language. The problem with a Turing machine is that there could be lots of different forms of intelligence and it doesn't take into account the inner state of the machine. If a machine or computer can pass the Turing test, it would be worthwhile to see how it's structured. Whether it has a thought process and mental state or just retrieving a database and giving an output. Having thought and giving output is not the same as retrieving files.

The best thought experiment to look out for this would be Chinese Room Arguments by John Searle. He says “Imagine a native English speaker who knows no Chinese locked in a room full of boxes of Chinese symbols together with a book of instructions or manipulating the symbols. Imagine the people outside the room sending in other Chinese symbols which are unknown to the person in the room. By following the instructions the man in the room is able to pass out the Chinese symbols. The program enables the person to pass the Turing test for understanding Chinese but doesn't understand the word of Chinese”.

The mind takes inputs, manipulates and gives outputs is nothing more than the simplest form of superficial explanation. To count something as thinking means to involve an understanding. What's made it salient by Searle's thought experiment is that it only works on syntactic properties of the symbol. It looks at the shape of the symbol and adds an answer depending on what the shape of the symbol is. In the case of humans, it is more complicated. Syntactic property is not enough to make anything meaningful. A semantic property is the key and takes a symbol to another dimension. Semantic properties are what that symbol stands for.

The computer doesn't need to understand the whole process to give an output. So, computers are like a human mind is a misleading metaphor. What's important for human thought are the semantic properties. For example, the question, do you like music? What it stands for is known as the semantic property of that symbol or question. To have a thinking system, it's important to have a system that has the syntactic properties and also understands the semantic properties of the symbols. That's how it gives the aboutness of thoughts.

Reviewing all the school of thoughts, it leads so far that psychological experience is not just a physical experience but both mental and physical experience. It's hard to say whether consciousness emerges from the complex structure of the brain or its properties of a mind. If it's true for the brain then a question arises, "if every neuron in a human is accurately stimulated, would that result in consciousness?" If not then there must be other factors that determine consciousness which is mind. And looking at the properties of the mental substance, it's questionable, sceptical and may be impossible to go that far and build immaterial substances that would compete with human beings. Also, it's unknown how immaterial substance affects changes in material substance. But, it seems we are far ahead of the time to use the metaphor "the human mind is like a computer".

Is it Okay to be Ordinary?

- Sunita Rana

One of the most common questions we used to be asked as a kid was “what is your aim? What do you want to become when you grow up?” This used to be my least favorite question. This particular question always used to make me perplexed. Even now in my mid-twenties, I don’t know what I want to be? Then what would a 12-year-old or 15-year-old me know about her ambitions and goals? However, we were brought up in such an environment that it is very important to have high ambitions and goals in life. If you don’t have any aims or can’t figure out what to do, you are considered as useless and good for nothing. So, when I was in school, I used to say I want to be a doctor since it is considered as a renowned profession and also, I was interested in helping people. Other common answers were engineer, pilot, nurse, and what else?

What I am trying to convey is we are always expected to be extraordinary and special. We are supposed to do something greatest and different than others in order to stand out. If you can’t do something different, you are considered as ordinary, just as an average person and so you go unnoticed. So, there is a kind of pressure to live an extraordinary life and be the best among others.

Okay let’s say, what if everyone strives to be extraordinary? If all of us will do something extraordinary, would it be extraordinary anymore?

Why are we trying to be special and extraordinary? Aren’t we already special and unique in our own ways? Is it really necessary to do something big to show our worth? What if I don’t want to be extraordinary? I’m really okay being an ordinary and normal human being. I’m okay if nobody notices me in the crowd. I’m okay if my dreams are not as big as yours. I’m okay if I’m just an average.

We are accustomed to follow the criteria of our society that are being fed since we are born. I’m worried we might lose our own value and uniqueness and forget to enjoy the essence of ordinary life while chasing the extraordinary life.

I don’t like the way our society treats the normal/ordinary people. What’s wrong being an ordinary? I’m not against those who are ambitious and trying to do something great. But what really annoys and bothers me is the way people are compared and judged with the predefined notions. I believe that everyone should be treated equally irrespective of their life choices and decisions and not on the

basis of what they do. Wanting to achieve greater things in life is not bad at all. But it's not necessary to be extraordinary to live a meaningful and happy life.

As I grew up, my ambitions, goals, and perception towards life kept changing over time and I believe it will continue to do so. Now, I feel like it's okay not to have so-called big ambitions and dreams in life. It's okay wanting to live a simple life. Every individual is different and he/she might have different life choices. There's nothing like big or small, you're allowed to have all kinds of dreams. Even if you can't figure out what you are doing or what you want to be, that's completely okay. You are still special and do not forget that.

So, if you ask me now, what do you want to be or what are you going to do in next five years? I don't have the answer but I want to do more of the things that makes me happy and content. I want to learn new things and keep growing. I want to make myself proud. I want to be a better human being.

Internet Addiction Disorder: Alert of Hazard

- Prabesh Raj Joshi

Before writing forward on about Internet Addiction, I was seeing a post of suicide confession of a boy through Facebook by cutting his nerves. I paused for a while, I was unsure to respond and tried to scan his psychosocial behavior through his previous updated status. In my mind there was previous scenario of live suicide video of two young girls (23 Years and 19 Years) from Dang and Chitwan in July, 2020 on Facebook. More than that, I was shocked from those peoples who react love, wow and like on those posts. It shows how the internet abuse affects the minds of people in daily life.

Can you also imagine a world without internet, social media, and technology? Oh! Are you getting scared of imagination too? But what, if one day you will be marked as one of the parts of internet addiction? Ask yourself. Your daily important technical equipment/ tools are grabbing you in its addiction. We even cannot go anywhere without it. We are being ruled by it. Our wake up routine to sleep time schedule is connected with our internet and technology tools. Our emotions, thoughts, feelings, and opinions are controlled by our tools. Which is known as the addiction disorder of the Internet.

Internet Addiction Disorder (IDA) also known as excessive internet use is generally defined as a next level of challenging issues in human life. Generally, more than our control, the device is controlling our daily schedule. Our device is controlling our daily routine and we are getting lost inside it. It is like a slow poison, which is seizing your energy, power and control in ourselves. Young (1998) states about IDA that was researched in 1996 by American Researcher in the study of over 600 cases. Young has categorized five specific types of Internet Addiction: 1) cyber sexual addiction to adult chat rooms or cyber porn; 2) cyber relationship addiction to online friendships or affairs that replace real-life situations; 3) net compulsions to online gambling, auctions, or obsessive trading; 4) information overload to compulsive web surfing or databases searches; and 5) computer addiction to game playing or programming. Internet Addiction Disorder (IAD) is a definition introduced for the first time by Ivan Goldberg in 1995. In his book he states that it describes the net addiction as “a pathology, a disorder, an overuse of this technology, including a wide range of behaviors and impulse-control. (Goldberg, 1995). Aboujaoude E (2010)

writes in his article that Internet addiction disorder (IAD), also called problematic or pathological Internet use, is characterized by an individual's inability to control his or her use of the Internet, which may eventually result in marked distress and functional impairments of general life such as academic performance, social interaction, occupational interest and behavioral problems. It is simply the changing of individual daily routines of human life due to the overuse of the Internet without controlling and caring. We are spending maximum time on the internet without knowing what we are really searching for. In the name of entertainment and update to self, we are out of control to our sinking mind in internet flow.

Ginige (2017) states in her article that in parts of the world where Internet gaming has an apparent high prevalence, relevant governments such as Chinese have accepted Internet gaming as an established “addiction” and South Korea have identified IA as a problem at governmental level and declared it a serious public health hazard.

Computer devices are not only stocked in desk now, it is in your lap, palm, wrist, ears, and eyes too. In study, office work, entertainment, sports, cultural activities, foods, and also in general life, technology devices and the internet is a part of our daily routine. The kids are denying food without seeing tab/ playing videos in-front of them. The new born baby has his/her own TikTok channel, YouTube channel, Facebook ID.

Some of the language, videos, and live speeches are difficult to watch together in family. Knowingly and unknowingly the maximum time was spent scrolling the screen without knowing what you are actually searching for. The culture of problem and challenging issues are changing after the globalization and internet age. With developing technology services, the utilization and abuse both are increasing rapidly. More than utilization, there seems to be abuse of the internet. Young minds are involved in hacking, bullying, cybercrimes, and the games on the internet are more violent. Last year, the Government of Nepal also banned PUBG, and many porn websites in 2019 by declaring the increase of bad impact on young people from it. In 2016, the game named “the blue whale challenge” increased child suicide between the age of 12 and 14 by self-harm activities. Mursaliyeva, Galina (2016). She states that only in Russia there were 130 suicide happened from November 2015 to April 2016 because of the manipulation of child minds from this internet self-harm challenge game. Nowadays, it is a serious issue for all the parents to control and care for their child's safe net. The curious minds are frenzied to drive anything in the browser due to the busy schedule of their parents. Nobody knows what is

going on in their mind? Knowingly and unknowingly porn videos, violent videos, and cyber illegal activities are in their finger touch in tab/phone and internet.

Alavy et. all (2011) states in their article that excessive internet use may create a heightened level of psychological arousal, resulting in little sleep, failure to eat for long periods, and limited physical activity, possibly leading to the user experiencing physical and mental health problems such as depression, obsessive-compulsive disorder, low family relationships and anxiety. It seems to many people in modern-era. The level of aggression, behavior change and depression in young and teenagers are increasing.

There are bad and good both things with everything as well as on the internet too. So, how we utilize the network is important. If we lose control in the self-using schedule of the Internet, the internet works slowly as slow-poison. We need to care for our child for a safe net. How they are using it is important to be guided, and we also need to be up to date about security, affects, and safety net to ourselves. It is not only about the abuse of the internet, but also how it is killing the self-control power of the human mind.

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Social Media and Technology Dilemma

-Sushant Bhatta

Have you ever wondered how social media and technologies are influencing your behavior? Why are we more and more addicted to them and do they handle us or we handle them?

The era of modernization where everything seems to be at our fingertips, but with the growth of technologies, it seems like we are becoming slaves.

On average, we spent 2 hours and 22 minutes per day on social networks and messaging apps according to the Global Web Index. More than half of the world now uses social media and 4.57 billion people use the internet around the world. Out of 4.57 billion internet users, 3.96 billion are active social media users.

Using the internet and technologies is not a bad thing at all. It helps us to connect throughout the world, know what's going in the world, about the recent trends, rules, and almost everything one can ever imagine. It helps us to stay updated on all kinds of information. And being up-to-date in today's competitive environment is necessary to sustain in the rat race of life. But there is always a BIG BUT, despite being so informative and helpful there are many cons of the internet especially social media and technologies. Let's see an overview of such cons.

Social Media: - When you listen to the word social media what comes to your mind? Normally people think about Facebook and other such media when they listen or read social media. But social media in general means a socializing platform where you exchange, share day to day activities, photos, videos, words, and so on. It's a new way of socializing own self. And unfortunately, nowadays we are more actively socializing on social media than in our real-life or I can also say, social media is influencing us to do so. When a person experiences something rewarding, neurons in the dopamine-producing areas in the brain are activated causing an increase in the level of dopamine. Therefore, the brain receives a "reward" and associates the activity with positive reinforcement. And using social media, when a person gets a notification, such as retweets, likes, shares, or mention, the brain receives a rush of dopamine and sends it along reward pathways, causing him or her to feel pleasure. Social media provides an endless number of such immediate rewards in the form of attention from others for relatively minimal effort.

Social media become problematic when people view these media as a coping mechanism to relieve loneliness, depression or stress. For them social media

provides endless rewards that they are not receiving in reality and end up being addicted more and more. And as a result, they grow many interpersonal problems like ignoring real life, work, relationships, duties and responsibilities, and even physical health. Also, they might have many psychological problems when they are forced not to use social media or when they don't receive the rewards as they were expecting or they will try to cope in a way to earn such rewards (as in adding filters, editing, or making the reel life perfect/happy even when they are unhappy in real life) that they forget about the reality of life.

Also, with the help of machine learning technologies, tech companies force us to stay and keep scrolling our phones by popping up videos or posts based on our previous information. And, sometimes when we are not active in social media for a long time, they notify us by sending new notifications related to our liked videos or posts to keep us engaged in social platforms. And we end up scrolling and chit-chatting for hours and hours.

Technologies: - We are living in an era where feature phones are replaced with smartphones, desktops with laptops, books with eBooks, and such transformations are growing in every field. When it comes to technology, we are inventing and using the latest and updated technologies that no one ever imagined will exist. And using those technologies are helping us to a certain extent to make our lives easy. We can make anything or travel anywhere in the world with the help of such advanced technologies. But research says with the development of AI (Artificial Intelligence) human jobs are in danger. As per an article in The Guardian the British daily newspaper, **restaurants are now employing robots**. According to a report by Chloe Taylor, a News Assistant at CNBC, **"Robots could take over 20 million jobs by 2030, study claims"**. We are too good at inventing and discovering things that we are being blind when it comes to knowing the consequences.

Like social media, technologies also have been a basic necessity of our life. We are being dependent day by day that we don't even care for our physical as well as mental health. We are ready to use and enjoy the short-term pleasures harming long-term outcomes. Even an over-excessive amount of food or medicine is harmful to us then what are these social media and technologies? As there is a famous saying, **"For gaining something we must sacrifice the other"**. Similarly, this is the case now. We are sacrificing our mental and physical health for gaining rewards from social media and easing life with technologies. And, Stephen Hawking has rightly observed: "Success in creating AI would be the biggest event in human history. Unfortunately, it might also be the last, unless we learn how to avoid the risks".

Emotional Intelligence

- Sarina Maharjan

Emotional intelligence(EI) refers to the capability of a person to manage and control his or her emotions and possess the ability to control the emotions of others as well. In other words, they can influence the emotions of other people also. EI is the area of cognitive ability that facilitates interpersonal behavior.

Brief History

The three key researchers in Emotional Intelligence are **Salovey and Mayer, Daniel Goleman and Reuven Bar-On**. **Reuven Bar-On** is an Israeli psychologist and one of the leading pioneers, theorists and researchers in emotional intelligence. Bar-On is thought to be the first to introduce the concept of an “EQ” (“Emotional Quotient”) to measure “emotional and social competence”. In 1982, Bar-On began developing the precursor of the Bar-On Emotional Quotient Inventory™ (EQ-i™), which was designed to study and assess the emotional and social competencies he identified.

Dr. John Mayer and Dr. Peter Salovey from American University developed the concept of EI. In 1990, psychologists Dr. John Mayer and Dr. Peter Salovey published their landmark article, "Emotional Intelligence," in the journal *Imagination, Cognition, and Personality*. They defined emotional intelligence as "the ability to monitor one's own and others' feelings and emotions, to discriminate among them, and to use this information to guide one's thinking and actions."

The term emotional intelligence was popularized in 1995 by American Psychologist and behavioral science journalist **Dr. Daniel Goleman** in his book, *Emotional Intelligence*. Dr. Goleman described emotional intelligence as a person's ability to manage his feelings so that those feelings are expressed appropriately and effectively. According to Goleman, emotional intelligence is the largest single predictor of success in the workplace.

Definition:

Reuven Bar-On defines Emotional Intelligence as “an array of non-cognitive capabilities, competencies, and skills that influence one’s ability to succeed in coping with environmental demands and pressures”. In the words of Salovey and Mayer emotional intelligence is “the ability to perceive emotions, to access and generate emotions so as to assist thought, to understand emotions and emotional knowledge, and to reflectively regulate emotions so as to promote emotional and

intellectual growth.” Goleman takes emotional intelligence as “the capacity for recognizing our own feelings and those of others, for motivating ourselves, and for managing emotions effectively in ourselves and others. An emotional competence is a learned capacity based on emotional intelligence that contributes to effective performance at work.”

Emotional intelligence has five main elements which are depicted as follows:

- Self-awareness
- Self-regulation/self-management
- Motivation
- Empathy
- Social skills

Self-awareness

If one is self-aware of what she/he is going through, she/he would be in a better position to understand others, and affect people around her/him. It also means she/he is aware of her/his strengths as well as weaknesses. When one experiences anger, one should hold that moment and think about what made her/him so angry. A person has a healthy sense of emotional intelligence and self-awareness if they understand their own strengths and weaknesses, as well as how their actions affect others. A person with emotional self-awareness is usually receptive to, and able to learn from, constructive criticism more than one who doesn't have emotional self-awareness.

Self-regulation

Self-regulation is the next step wherein one should think before speaking. It is an important aspect where one can regulate herself/himself. This will impact others in a positive way rather than negatively. One should hold self accountable in case she/her makes a mistake, and try to remain calm in every situation. A person with a high emotional intelligence has the ability to exercise restraint and control when expressing their emotions.

Motivation

When one is motivated to do a series of tasks she/he will be in a better position to influence others. One should work towards her/his goals consistently. Even if she/he faces challenges, she/he should try and find something good about the situation. People with high emotional intelligence are self-motivated, resilient and driven by

an inner ambition rather than being influenced by outside forces, such as money or prestige.

Empathy

When one is able to put herself /himself in other's shoes and think about a situation, it is known as empathy. One should know how to empathize with others, if she/he wants to earn their respect. An empathetic person has compassion and is able to connect with other people on an emotional level, helping them respond genuinely to other people's concerns.

Social skills

The last aspect is social skills and it is one of the important aspects. Social skills are all about communicating your point of view to. They are able to build a rapport with others which makes the relationship more comfortable. People who are emotionally intelligent are able to build trust with other people, and are able to quickly gain respect from the people they meet.

Importance of Emotional Intelligence

Traditionally IQ has always been thought to be very important to achieve success in life. However not all intelligent people are successful. Emotional intelligence is a key factor that contributes to success in not only the workplace but also in social relationships and life in general. Increased emotional intelligence positively affects the following:

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------|
| • Psychological Health | • Work performance |
| • Teamwork | • Conflict management |
| • Patient/Client satisfaction | • Coaching Skills |
| • Employability and Re-employment | • Workplace Incivility |
| • Institutional Climate | • Job Satisfaction |

Use of Emotional Intelligence

Emotional intelligence can be used in many different ways in our daily life. Some different ways to practice emotional intelligence include:

- Being able to accept criticism and responsibility
- Being able to move on after making a mistake
- Being able to say no when required
- Being able to share feelings with others

- Being able to solve problems in ways that work for everyone
- Having empathy for other people
- Having great listening skills
- Knowing why we do the things we do
- Not being judgmental of others

Assessment of Emotional Intelligence

The 2 most widely used tools to measure EQ are the MSCEIT and the EQ-i 2.0.

MSCEIT- The Mayer-Salovey-Caruso Emotional Intelligence Test

Based on Mayer and Salovey's work this test is quite similar to an IQ test with specific measures and right and wrong answers. There are some limitations with this test in how the developers obtained the “right” answers. They used standard populations and the debate is, in research about emotions, can be right and wrong answers. The test is designed to measure one's innate or inborn EQ and as such can indicate someone's ability to learn EQ skills. The MSCEIT is like an IQ test, predicting how well someone can learn.

EQ-i-2.0 - Emotional Quotient Inventory and EQ 360

Based on Bar-On's Model of Emotional-Social Intelligence, the EQi 2.0, is probably the most used EQ measure. The EQ-i 2.0 is a self-report measure and the EQ 360 2.0 is a full assessment that looks at how others perceive oneself. After completing the EQi 2.0 a report is generated that indicates areas of strengths and weaknesses within each of the 15 skills of Bar-On's model that can then be addressed.

EQ-i 2.0 and EQ 360 Composite Scales and Subscales

Self-Perception	Interpersonal	Decision Making	Self-Expression	Stress Management
• Self-Regard • Self-Actualization • Emotional Self Awareness	• Interpersonal Relationships • Empathy • Social Responsibility	• Problem Solving • Reality Testing • Impulse Control	• Emotional Expression • Assertiveness • Independence	• Flexibility • Stress Tolerance • Optimism

(Sarinaji, better to enlist your references)

Psychosocial Works in Juvenile Justice: A Nepali Context

-Rabindra Bhattarai

Abstract

Juvenile justice is a form of social justice to children where the breaking of the law concerns them. Nepal has developed and operated its own framework of juvenile justice and psychologists/psychological experts and social workers are envisaged as one of the key actors of the system. However, there are conceptual dilemmas in the legal framework regarding this and there is urgency to rethink the existing framework and improve in terms of policy, law and mechanism dealing psychosocial services by professionals with professional competencies. This piece of writing proposes some thought for rethinking for reform.

Introduction

Juvenile justice is a branch of national justice mechanism as a 'system of laws, policies, and procedures intended to regulate the processing and treatment of non-adult offenders for violations of law and to provide legal remedies that protect their interests in situations of conflict or neglect' Shoemaker & Jensen (2020). It is a division of the social system rendering justice to the children in conflict with the law or in contact with law. 'Children in conflict with the law' is anyone under 18 who comes into contact with the justice system as a result of being suspected or accused of committing an offence (UNICEF, 2006). Children in contact with the law are those children who come into contact with the justice system as a result of victimization or witnessing offence. Juvenile justice regulates reparations to the victim and holding the offender responsible at personal, community and societal levels.

Juvenile justice applies with due consideration to adolescents developmental, cognitive, emotional, behavioural aspects in socio-personal settings. Health concerns such as depression, anxiety, and other disorders that might have impacted the behaviour confronting the law (Levy, 2019). Thus, efforts are to be made addressing the root causes of delinquencies (Silwal, 2012: 114). Juveniles dragged to the justice system might have mental disorders caused by offending or victimization.

The justice processes are investigation, diversion, prosecutorial proposal and disposition and correctional measures which require sufficient attention on psychosocial concerns. Healthcare with effective psychosocial support undeniably dispensed. Therefore, psychosocial professionals have crucial roles to play in juvenile justice.

Nepali Model of Juvenile Justice

Various models of juvenile justice are in practice around the globe, Nepal has its own. The Constitution of Nepal 2015 and Children Act 2018 have launched a more advanced juvenile justice model than previously. Children Act 'revising the previous Act in the context of Constitution in 2015, is consistent with Convention of the Rights of Child (CRC), guarantees 13 fundamental rights of children' (NCRC, 2019: 03). The Children Act 2018 recognizes the role of psychosocial work as a part of justice to children in conflict/contact with law.

About 30 years back, Nepal introduced juvenile justice in line with CRC following its ratification on 14 Sep 1990. Children Act 1992 promulgated in 1992, brought into force by 1993 (Bhattarai & Karki, 2020: 46). A Juvenile Bench at the District Court comprising a District Judge, a Social Worker and a Child Psychologist was operated by 2000 (Keeling & Bhattarai, 2000: 57) but the boarded psychologists and social workers' roles remained unclear till 2006. Juvenile Justice Procedural Regulations 2006 provided a collective jurisdiction for the bench and social worker and psychologist could present their opinion before the judge. Additionally, the Regulations had introduced a system of social inquiry report during the investigation of the case and Rule 4 (G) had obliged the investigator to ask service provider individual or institution to prepare and provide a social inquiry report in the structure as required by annexed Schedule in Regulations, however, the roles and tasks of psychologists were unarticulated. Children Act 2018 has more significantly recognized the increased role of psychosocial works.

Social Work and Psychological Support Envisaged in the System

Chapter 4 of the Children Act 2018, titled as "On Juvenile Justice", describes the process of justice in relation to allegedly committed delinquency (KASURJANYA KARYA). The Apprehension and custody of the juvenile in observation room, investigation of the case, diversion/prosecution, adjudication (trial and sentencing), placements of juveniles (Parental, Community and Correctional facility) return and reintegration of the juvenile (Section 55) back into the community settings are described. The Act recognizes the police, the prosecutor, the court (judge and

administration), psychologist, social worker, probation officer, defence lawyer, personnel of correctional facilities, child welfare officer as key role players. Bhattarai & Karki (2020) have indicated following scope of psychosocial service and support as follows:

Stage	Scope	Performable Roles
Investigation	Screening Social Inquiry Report Assessment Counselling	- Screening and assessment of psychosocial problems - Initial counselling - Referral to other appropriate health services
Diversion (of both sides victim and offender as for as applicable)	Social Inquiry Report Psychosocial Report Screening/Assessment Counselling Report	- Screening and assessment of psychosocial problems - Initial counselling - Referral to other appropriate health services - Report of psychosocial status
Trial	Assessment Hearing Opinion report	- Counselling - Review of psychosocial reports - Assessment of psychosocial problems and state of the juveniles - Recommendation of psychosocially appropriate treatments and therapies - Opinion report
Post-trial	Service at Correctional facility	- Counselling - Re-assessment and follow-up of psychosocial state of juveniles - Observation, documentation and reporting of the improvement of the juveniles attained psychosocially
Aftercare	Community setting	- Counselling - Re-assessment and follow-up of psychosocial state of juveniles - Observation, documentation and reporting of the improvement of the juveniles attained psychosocially

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Notion of Psychosocial Support and Legal Provision

Breach of law by a child indicates a psychosocial and public health issue. Clinicians, policy makers, researchers and advocates have devoted their attention to it. Number of youths in the justice system present elevated levels of mental health

needs (Maniadaki et al, 2019: 2). Mental health problems in detained youths are unclear from the origins of delinquency to the consequence of detention, or third variables (Wierson et al, 1992: 93-120; cited in Maniadaki et al, 2019).

Mental health concerns psychological and social issues. "A state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity" (WHO, 2020a). Mental health is a state of well-being of an individual realizing own abilities, coping with the normal stresses of life, work productively; and is fundamental to our ability to think, emote, interact with each other, earn a living and enjoy life. The promotion, protection and restoration of mental health is a vital concern (WHO, 2020b). Therefore, social and psychological support as part of mental health service are indispensable constituents of juvenile justice.

The terms "SAMAJSEWI" and "BALMANOVIJYA or BALVISHESHAJYA" are denotative to psychosocial professionals in Children Act 2018 "SAMAJSEWI" is defined as 'a person referred to in Section 62' (NLC, 2018:3) but "BALMANOVIJYA or BALVISHESHAJYA" are not defined in any form. However, many references are made on social, psychosocial and psychological support and concerns in different provisions.

More specifically Sections 45 and 62 of the Act articulate the role of psychosocial services: **Section 45. Psycho-sociological and psychological study report:** (1) An individual psycho- sociological and psychological study report shall be prepared for the purpose of investigation, prosecution, proceeding, hearing or adjudication of the charge made against a child in conflict with law. (2) The provisions regarding the preparation of the study report referred to in sub-section (1) shall be as prescribed. **Section 62: Social service provider and child psychologist:** (1) Any persons willing to work as social service providers and child psychologists shall get their names enlisted themselves with the Local Child Rights Committee, as prescribed. (2) Social service providers and child psychologists may be appointed in required number, from among the social service providers and child psychologists enlisted in the list referred to in sub-section (1), for carrying out child protection related acts and delivering services at the Local Level. **(3) The social service providers and child psychologists appointed pursuant to sub-section (2) shall act under the direct guidance and supervision of the child welfare authority. (4) The social service providers and child psychologists required for the juvenile court shall be appointed from among the social service providers and child psychologists enlisted pursuant to sub-section (1). ...** (NLC, 2018: 21, 27).

Above provisions are further elaborated in the Juvenile Justice Performance (Procedures) Regulations 2019. Rule 7 requires while investigating juveniles, the investigator to cause check-up of the physical and mental health juvenile at government hospital or doctor nearby, to make available counselling service by Child Psychological Expert or Psychosocial support, and to cause a social inquiry report of the juvenile by Social Worker. However, the Regulations do not explicitly detail the roles and responsibilities of the social worker and psychologist for the entire course of juvenile justice but Rule 39 prescribes templates for social inquiry report, psychosocial or psychological study report. The template under this rule as annexed as Schedule 9 and 10 outline screening frames of basic socio-economic and personal information of juveniles (Bhattarai & Karki, 2020).

Systemic Dilemma on Psychosocial Service and Support in Juvenile Justice

Juvenile justice should take care of promotional, preventive and remedial aspects of juveniles' deviant behaviours. Preventing delinquency prevents the onset of adult criminal careers (Greenwood, 2008: 186). From a development perspective, juveniles fall under adolescence, the age of tremendous psychophysical changes with cognitive, psychological and social transitions with many alterations (Shrestha, 2012: 327). Adolescents may have high propensity of deviant, antisocial and destructive behaviours. Biological, psychological and socio-cultural factors play roles in causing deviance in juveniles and deviant behaviours either in externalized (irritability, belligerence, aggressive or disruptive etc.) or internalized (anxiety disorder, depressive disorders, dependency) pattern (Bhatta, 2012: 339-340).

The term "psychosocial" is generally referred to as relating to the interrelation of social factors and individual thought and behaviour. It came as part of healthcare and psychology implies a relationship between psychological and social factors including learning and following culturally appropriate social codes and development hinges on social relationships (PCHWC, 2003: 01-02). Social work as: "a practice-based profession and an academic discipline that promotes social change and development, social cohesion, and the empowerment and liberation of people. Principles of social justice, human rights, collective responsibility and respect for diversities are central to social work. ... social work engages people and structures to address life challenges and enhance wellbeing. The above definition may be amplified at national and/or regional levels"(GDSWP, 2014). Social works encompass correction, criminal, juvenile justice settings and social workers also practice in the area of behavioural health and case management (Nikku, 2012: 408). Therefore, psychosocial services are inevitably parts of juvenile justice.

Psychosocial services are interwoven as essential ancillary to the justice system from intake to outlet of an individual as victim or offender within it. Therefore, there is a need for clarity on their roles, scope and collaborative framework; however, the Act neither prescribes preventive policies nor psychosocial intervention to the same.

The Act has sought the roles of psychosocial services as mentioned above under heading *Social Work and Psychological Support Envisaged in the System* as remedial but fails to maintain the standards of social work and psychological service from qualification and competent perspective. Rules 13 and 14 of Juvenile Justice Procedural Regulations 2019 assumes any person graduated in any subject and taken training of one to two months in respective fields could be Social Worker and Psychologist (Bhattarai & Karki, 2020: 265-266) and recognizes their role only for juvenile bench. Who and how in the rest of the area of juvenile justice offer psychosocial services from intake to outlet of the system of juvenile justice?

Psychosocial services might be from primary to tertiary levels and human resources to be involved would also be ranging from social worker (who could be primary screener of psychosocial problems), Counsellor, Clinical Psychologist and Psychiatric Doctor accordingly but the law classifies none. The law put two types of tasks, i.e. social and psychological and assumes these are absolutely independent to each other whereas social work and psychological work might have to work for the same causes, particularly in relation to the screening, assessing the psychosocial problems with complementarities.

Conclusion

By above discussion it is clear that there is a need for a blended comprehensive framework of psychosocial work instead of separating social work and psychosocial work. It is also that for the arrangement of at least one person serving in each of the stages of pre-trial, trial, post-trial and aftercare (community) of juveniles, policy, law and mechanism are to be reframed. It is necessary to ensure that psychosocial services are to be provided in the initial stage for screening, during investigation and diversion (screening, assessment, referral and counselling), trial (hearing, opinion and counselling), post trial (reassessing, referral, counselling) and aftercare (adjustment skills and counselling family and community).

A foremost urgency is implementation of a system of screening at the intake of juveniles (both victim and accused) and screening and assessment thereto. A variety of tools to be used to identify mental health needs through screening and

assessment. Therefore, it seems also important to develop necessary tools and prepare human resource to offer competently effective services to the system and the individual youths subjected. If psychosocial services are effectively employed in the remedial system of juvenile deviant and delinquent behaviours, that would significantly useful for prevention in the days to come.

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Should I Always Put Headphones on?

- Rajan Tiwari

Have you ever punched somebody directly in the face since s/he was making a few irksome sounds? All things considered, I have completed a few times; deliberately or unknowingly. You may think what sort of crazy person would do that, on the off chance that if you have ever heard or thought about the turmoil called misophonia, it would not be a surprise for you.

What is **misophonia**? Simply put, **misophonia** is a strong dislike or hatred of certain sounds; usually, those made by others, and usually ones that other people don't pay attention to. The condition is sometimes called selective sound sensitivity syndrome. It can be described as an immediate and extreme emotional response of anger accompanied with an automatic physiological flight response and a fundamental discomfort to identifiable auditory, visual, and olfactory stimuli.

Misophonia is not listed in any of the contemporary psychiatric classification of mental or emotional disorders. Despite these extreme reactions that people experience, it is still not recognized as a disorder. Some researchers have argued that misophonia should be regarded as a new mental disorder, falling within the spectrum of obsessive-compulsive related disorders. Other researchers have disputed this claim. One thing is certain that the brain of people with misophonia is wired to react to sounds differently. The disorder disrupts daily living and can have a significant impact on all social interactions.

I have a lesser-realized mind condition that has caused my public and private life testing than I ever could have imagined. Not a day passes by where I do not experience the agony of misophonia. Regardless of where I go, what I do, and how hard I attempt to anticipate it, another trigger will be around the bend and another. This can lead to a lot of isolation.

Indeed, I abhor a few sounds, yet not all sounds. Regardless, I appreciate music. I cherish the sound of wind and thunder. Be that as it may, there are a few sounds that I despise with enthusiasm. It's scorn however, it's more than that but on the other hand, it's not as much as that. One experiences the life and death situation when it's just his/her friend eating chips. It can turn everyday activities like dinner with your family, interacting with friends, and even watching a movie into torture. Envision you are sitting at a table dining with your family and suddenly you want to strangle one of your family member's neck just to comply with your inner turmoil.

That dinner table with your family would be loaded up with clamors. The scratching of a fork against a plate, the biting of popcorn, the slurping of a beverage, even the sound of somebody gulping or relaxing. Every one of these things and make that dinner table hellfire for those of us with misophonia.

Some of you without misophonia might think "well everyone gets annoyed by certain sounds", STOP that idea right now. For people with misophonia, the reaction happens even before they think about it. Since it is neurological, the actual reaction takes place in the brain. Misophonia is more than a disturbance, it's needed to shout since somebody's breathing excessively noisy. It's needing to punch somebody who's smacking their gum. It's needing to rip your very own ears off because you can't get away from the clamor. Hello, if Van Gogh could cut off his ear, possibly I could also do it, right? That idea enters my mind more regularly than it presumably should.

Memes jokes and other forms of "wow this is a disorder hahaha!!" have done little more than mimic the dunce cap of old. We stroll in disgrace of our mind. Atop of our already challenging condition we are forced to live in a brutal world of sound stimuli. The bus, the supermarket, workplace, school. The intense light, the creepy sound, all assault any place we go.

Meanwhile me in my pyre: Aww I forgot my earphones...

The Artist of Life

Amidst many events of life, I grew
 Amidst many struggles, I grew
 Shifting from places to places, I grew
 Meeting people and sharing stories, I grew
 I grew at my own pace, with my own struggles and my own insecurities
 Little by little I grew
 Growing up like a Canvas with all kinds of colors, strokes, textures and smell
 A Canvas yet to be a masterpiece
 I am growing.....

I spent my childhood moving from one place to another, one family to another and one school to another. It is said that growing up with parents is important for the growth of a child, which might be true but in my case, growing up with different families might somehow have helped me understand people. It turned me into an adult who is curious about exploring places, meeting people, knowing stories, imagining myself in those stories and learning something new about myself.

Following that same curiosity I was in Surkhet in 2019. At the terrace of a hotel listening to a 19 year old girl sharing her story. In a strong voice and emotional tone she was saying: "I even had thoughts of ending my life as everything around me changed with that incident, I failed my high school exams, I lost my hair, my head is scarred, I was a burden to my family and it was too difficult to accept the new me and accept my new life" and with a shy giggle added "and I can't live my dream of becoming a model now."

This 19 years old girl is Laxmi from Kalikot. The eldest child along with 4 younger sisters and a younger brother. She was living a simple life with her parents in Manma, Kalikot until one day when she had this huge accident at the rice mill which was the earning source of their family. Her hair got stuck on a running belt of a rice mill and her head was seriously injured. She was rescued and somehow brought to Kathmandu for treatment. She went through 2 surgeries and with the grace of God managed to survive but was left permanently bald and scarred after the treatment.

This incident took place a year ago and now I was meeting her in Surkhet to take her to Kathmandu, which is where I live now, to help her with her further education and skill development. My curiosity of meeting people, knowing stories and imagining myself in those stories was somehow challenged because hearing her story, I was not able to imagine myself at her position, I couldn't think about the amount of courage and strength she could have had to go through all of that, accept that, not give up even when she felt like and now trying to break her comfort zone by coming to Kathmandu all alone.

It was like a Canvas that was painted half way through and got scarred by something and the emotional dilemma an artist feels when one part of them wants to give their all to fix what is broken and another part just wants to discard everything and start all over again.

But the beauty of the canvas of life is that you have to accept and fix things first in order to start all over again because there is only one Canvas.

I could feel in her stern voice the work, the resilience and the patience she must have had to be able to endure the physical and mental pain, accept her new self, accept the new ways people started seeing her, talking to her and pitied her.

"I couldn't show my scars to even my beloved brother or anyone in my family for a long time, for I thought they too would not be able to accept the new me. I used to wear a cap all the time even if it burned my head because I didn't want to scare them with my scars. I would feel like I was a burden to my parents, I couldn't tell them whenever I had discomfort in my head because I knew they couldn't afford to take me to the hospital in Kathmandu for follow ups. "

Until that morning the only strong person I ever knew in my life was my mother, who also had been through allot in a young age. She was able to stand up for herself and leave her bad marriage without fearing to break the norms of the society. She gathered the confidence to paint her life differently and didn't succumb to the hard situation. Now looking back, I completely feel it's her decision that shaped my life and her decision that now guides me to fearlessly live life.

That morning, Laxmi was also added to my list of strong people. In that terrace I explained to her about our project that was going to support her in Kathmandu for her education and health checkups. Project Canvas supports Canvases during a phase of their life where they need extra strength to not give up on themselves and their dreams. We all want a support system when we hit a rock bottom, to be able

to stand up and continue our journey of being our own kind of masterpiece. Project Canvas tries to be that support system.

Now, when I am writing this in 2022 I can reflect on our work, Project Canvas, which merely started by the initiation of two people , Me and Kamal, due to our common interest towards community, society, people, stories and social welfare.

To be able to be a part of Laxmi's journey from Kalikot to Kathmandu has been a delightful experience. Struggling to adjust to a new lifestyle, new place, new roads and new people while keeping the learning attitude alive was really inspirational to witness. The confidence she gathered by living life one day at a time and accepting herself was visible when she went back to Kalikot to give one training to her community people. The same people she said had started pitying her were now praising her for who she had become.

As a psychology student I have an inclination towards famous Psychologist Carl Rogers who believed that every human has all the resources within themselves to reach their highest potential and right now I remember his saying “ People are just as wonderful as sunsets if you let them be. When I look at a sunset, I don't find myself saying “ Soften the orange a bit on the right hand corner”, I don't try to control the sunset, I watch with awe as it unfolds.”

We, the team of Project Canvas, just supported her with basic necessities and a non-judgmental environment and stayed aback and witnessed her journey, her strength, her willingness to be more than she was a day before.

We have supported two people through this project in the span of 2 years though our plan was to support many but this has been an incredible journey. I aspire to travel a lot more in this journey of meeting new people, listening to new stories, imagining myself in those stories and discovering the resources I have within myself in that process. I want to learn the art of living from people like my mother and Laxmi and many more whom I am yet to meet.

... Canvas in making...

- Puja Sharma

President at Sky is the Limit – an organization that works to educate, engage and empower youths and children of Nepal

बालमनोविज्ञान र मेरो अनुभव

- प्रमिला खनाल

प्रत्येक अभिभावक आफ्ना बच्चा आज्ञाकारी, मेहनती एवम् अनुशासित भएको हेर्न चाहन्छन् । त्यस्ता छोराछोरीका आमा-बाबा आफूलाई सफल अनि भाग्यमानी पनि ठान्ने गर्दछन् । सफल अभिभावक बन्न सक्नु जति गर्वको कुरा हो छोराछोरीलाई सफल बनाउन सक्नु बाबुआमाका लागि चुनौतिपूर्ण कुरा हुन्छ । हेर्दा सामान्य लागे पनि बच्चा हुर्काउने क्रममा अभिभावकले बालमनोविज्ञानका अनगिन्ती सजिला र अफ्टयारा अवस्थाहरू पार गर्नुपर्छ । भनिन्छ - बच्चाहरू गिलो माटोसरह हुन्छन्, हामी उनीहरूलाई जस्तो आकार दिन्छौं त्यस्तै बन्छन् । आकार दिने क्रममा हामीबाट अलिकति मात्र त्रुटि भयो भने पनि बच्चाहरूको भविष्यमा समस्या आउन सक्छन् । अहिलेको युगमा बच्चाहरूको पालनपोषणको गर्ने तरिका पनि समयसुहाउँदो हुनुपर्छ । अचेलभरिका बच्चा आफ्नो अभिभावकभन्दा धेरै तगडा (स्मार्ट) छन् । मोबाइलमा कलिङ र रिसिभिङ गर्न मात्र जान्ने अभिभावकका बच्चा मोबाइलका सम्पूर्ण स्वरूप र पार्टपुर्जासम्मको जानकारी राख्छन् ।

हामी सात वर्षको हुँदाको ज्ञानभन्दा अहिलेको सात वर्षको बच्चाको ज्ञान र बौद्धिक क्षमता बढी र भिन्न छ । यस्ता बच्चाहरूका संवेगहरू बुझ्न र उनीहरूबाट आदर पाउन हामी अभिभावक पनि समय र प्रवृत्तिअनुसार अपग्रेड हुन जरुरी छ । तर अहिले अधिकांश आमा-बाबा आफ्नो वृत्ति उन्मुख भएका छन् र आफ्ना बालबच्चाको भविष्यका लागि बाबा-आमा दुवै कामकाजी बन्नुपर्ने बाध्यता पनि छ । त्यसैले अहिले अभिभावकले आफ्ना बच्चाहरूलाई पर्याप्त समय दिन सक्दैनन् । अझ कति अभिभावक त कार्यालय वा कामबाट समयमै घर फर्के पनि आफ्नो बालबच्चाहरूलाई समय दिनुभन्दा भन्दा इन्टरनेट वा सामाजिक सञ्जालमा भुन्डिरहन्छन् । आफ्नो बच्चाहरूलाई गृहकार्य गरिस् ? खाना खाइस् ? जाँचमा कति कम अंक वा अक्षरांकन ल्याएको? भन्न मात्र समय निकाल्छन् । प्रविधिको कारण टाढा रहेका मानिस नजिक हुन्छन्, उनीहरूसँग घन्टी कुरा गर्न समय निस्कन्छ तर घरमा सँगै भएका बच्चाहरूसँग एकछिन् बसेर कुरा गर्न उनीहरूलाई समयै हुँदैन । प्रविधिका कारण धेरै अभिभावकहरूसँग आफ्ना बच्चाहरूको सम्बन्ध वा स्नेहबन्धन विस्तारै कम हुँदै गैरहेको छ । सामाजिक सञ्चारमाध्यम र मोबाइल फोन नहुँदा अभिभावक र बच्चाहरूबीच त्यति समस्या थिएनन् तर आज प्रविधिको विकास क्रमसँगै अभिभावक र बच्चाबीचको सम्बन्ध पनि खराब हुँदै गएको देख्न सकिन्छ । हामी अभिभावकहरूले उनीहरूलाई पर्याप्त ध्यान दिन नसक्दा र अस्वस्थकर पारिवारिक वातावरणले गर्दा बाल्यकालमा बालबालिकामा धेरै प्रकारका मनोवैज्ञानिक समस्या आउन सक्छन् ।

बालबालिकाका लागि छ वर्षदेखि १२ वर्षसम्मको उमेरसमय निरपेक्ष महत्त्वपूर्ण समय हो । यस अवस्थामा बालबालिकाका शारीरिक मात्र होइन, संवेगात्मक, सञ्ज्ञानात्मक, बौद्धिक र मनोवैज्ञानिक आधारशिला तयार भइसक्छन् । सोही आधारशिलाअनुसार आजीवन कायम रहने सिर्जनशीलता र रचनात्मकताको पनि विकास हुन्छ । यसैले हामी बालबालिकालाई सधैं प्रतिभा, सम्भावना र भविष्यका कर्णधारका रूपमा हेर्छौं । बालबालिकाको मानसिक, बौद्धिक, संवेगात्मक, सञ्ज्ञानात्मक तथा बौद्धिक स्वास्थ्य विकासका लागि उनीहरूलाई उपलब्ध गराउने वातावरण, अवसर र शैक्षिक क्रियाकलापको भूमिका ज्यादै हुन्छ । स्वसकारात्मकता (सेल्फ पोजिटिभ कन्सेप्ट), सकारात्मक अभिवृत्ति (पोजिटिभ एटिच्युड), आत्मविश्वास (सेल्फ कन्फिडेन्स) र संवेगात्मक स्थिरता (इमोसनल स्टाबिलिटी) जस्ता अनुकूल पक्षको विकासका लागि अनुकूल वातावरण अपरिहार्य हुन्छ ।

अभिभावकत्वको १४औं वर्षमा प्रवेश गर्दै गर्दा मैले पनि बालमानोविज्ञानसँग सम्बन्धित धेरै कुराको अनुभव बटुल्ने मौका पाएको छु । एघार वर्ष पहिले मैले देखेको एउटा शिक्षित र सम्पन्न परिवारको घटनाले मेरो जीवनमा बालबालिका हुर्काउने धारणामा नै आमूल हेरफेर गराएको थियो । डाक्टर बाबा र नर्स आमाले आफ्नो कलिलो बालकलाई हरेक भौतिक सुविधा उपलब्ध गराए पनि सानैदेखि घरमा घरेलु सहयोगीको जिम्मामा छोड्नाले बच्चाहरूले गहिरो संवेगात्मक समस्याको सिकार हुनुपरेको थियो । त्यो बाबुको मानसिक र मनोवैज्ञानिक पक्ष मजबुत बनाउन मनोविमर्शकर्ता र मानसिक चिकित्सकलाई धेरै लामो समय मात्र लागेको थिएन, समाधान निकाल्न हम्मेहम्मे नै परेको थियो । आफूले देखेका यस्ता केही घटनाले गर्दा मैले आफ्नो राम्रै अगाडि बढ्दै गरेको वृत्तिविकासलाई भन्दा बालबच्चाहरूलाई बढी महत्त्व दिएँ । कामकाजी महिला भएर पाएको खुसी, अनुभव र आत्मसन्तुष्टिभन्दा बालबच्चाको लालनपालनमा दिएको समयले मलाई बेजोडको खुसी, आत्मसन्तुष्टि र सिकाइ प्राप्त भएको छ । त्यो मातृवात्सल्यबाट प्राप्त भएको मीठो अनुभूतिले मलाई जीवनभर ऊर्जा मिलिराख्छ भन्ने लाग्छ ।

मेरो अनुभवका केही महत्त्वपूर्ण पाठ

१. सबैभन्दा पहिले त बच्चा मानसिक रूपमा स्वास्थ्य हुन घरको वातावरण राम्रो हुनुपर्छ । अभिभावक (आमा-बाबा) बीचको सम्बन्ध र स्नेहबन्धन सधैं राम्रो हुनुपर्छ ।
२. हामी बच्चाहरूलाई बिहान उठेदेखि नसुतेसम्म, यो गरा! त्यो गरा! यसरी गरा! भनेर आदेश मात्र दिदै समावेशकको भूमिका खेल्छौं, उनीहरूले गर्नुपर्ने कामको निर्णय हामी नै गरिदिन्छौं तर बच्चाहरू हुर्काउँदा हाम्रो भूमिका अभिभावकीय मात्र हुनुपर्छ; उनीहरूसम्बन्धी विषयमा निर्णय लिनुअगाडि उनीहरूको अभिमत र राय के छ? त्यस विषयमा उनीहरू कसरी सोच्छन् र के सोच्छन् भन्ने कुरा राख्न उनीहरूलाई सर्वदा अवसर मिल्नुपर्छ ।
३. बच्चाहरूलाई अरुसँग कहिल्यै तुलना गर्नुहुँदैन, यसो गर्नाले उनीहरू आफूलाई कमजोर महसुस गर्छन्, आत्मविश्वासमा कमी आउन सक्छ र तुलना गर्नाले बच्चामा सकारात्मक भन्दा नकारात्मक प्रभाव बढी पर्न सक्छ ।
४. खास गरी हामी अभिभावक रिसाउँदा जुन शब्दले गाली गर्छौं बच्चाहरूले पनि तेही शब्द आफू रिसाउँदा प्रयोग गर्छन्, त्यसैले हामीले बोल्दा सधैं सभ्य र सकारात्मक शब्द र भाषा प्रयोग गर्नुपर्छ ।
५. बच्चा विद्यालयबाट घर फर्किनासाथ जाँचमा कति अंक आयो? भन्नुको सट्टा आज विद्यालयमा तिमीलाई मन पर्ने वा खुसी हुने कुरा के भयो? तिमीले नयाँ कुरा केही सिक्‍यो? वा कसैलाई सहयोग गर्यौं? जस्ता प्रश्न गरेर कुरा सोध्नुपर्छ ।
६. बच्चाहरू घरमा धेरै उफ्रिँदा, धेरै हाँस्दा, चिच्याउँदा हामीलाई रिस उठ्ने, भर्को लाग्ने हुन सक्छ तर बच्चाहरूका त्यस्ता क्रियाकलाप स्वाभाविक हुन् भन्ने कुराको हेक्का राख्ने पर्छ ।
७. हामी बच्चाको हरेक कुरामा मद्दत गरिरहेको छौं भने वास्तवमा त्यो सहयोग वा मद्दत नभएर उनीहरूको परनिर्भरता बढाउनु चाहिँ हो । उनीहरूले सक्ने काम उनीहरूलाई नै गर्न छोडिदिनु सबैभन्दा राम्रो मद्दत

६२ । विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्मारिका

हो । गृहकार्य गर्न, परियोजना कार्य गर्न हामी जति कम सहयोग गर्छौं त्यति नै उनीहरू आफ्नो काम आफैले गर्ने हो भन्ने आदत विकास गर्न तल्लीन रहन्छन् ।

८. बच्चाहरूले कार्टुन हेर्छन् भने केही समय हेर्न दिनु राम्रो कुरा हो, हामीले सिकाउन नसकेको धेरै कुरा बच्चाहरूले कार्टुन हेरेर पनि सिक्किरहेको हुन्छन् ।
९. घरमा हरेक दिन बेलुकी ३०-४० मिनेटको “शून्य समय” को संस्कार हामीले बसाल्नुपर्छ । शून्य समयमा टिभी, इन्टरनेट, फोन, ट्याबलेट, कम्प्युटर सबै बन्द गरेर बच्चाहरूसँग पारिवारिक कुराकानी गर्ने र उनीहरूलाई पनि आफ्नो विचारहरू राख्ने मौका दिनुपर्छ ।
१०. बच्चाहरूलाई बेवास्ता गर्दा, ध्यान नदिँदा र उनीहरूले गर्न खोजेको काम रोक्न खोज्दा मात्र बच्चाहरू रिसाउने गर्छन् । अवचेतन मनमा बच्चाहरू कहिल्यै गलत हुँदैनन्, त्यसैले बच्चाहरूलाई सधैं माया गरौं र तिनको विश्वासबाट आफू कहिल्यै च्युत हुने गल्ती नगरौं ।

जीवनको सार्थकता

- शंकर रसिक

जसको मन तपाईंमा अडिएको छ, त्यसलाई तपाईंले पूरा शान्तिमा राख्नु हुन्छ किनभने त्यसले तपाईं माथि भरोसा राख्छ । हरेक मानिसको जीवनलाई कुनै न कुनै चीजले हाँकिरहेको हुन्छ । हुन सक्छ त्यो सकारात्मक तत्त्व वा नकारात्मक तत्त्वले मार्गदर्शन गरेको हुन्छ । हाँक्नु भनेको गाइड गर्नु, नियन्त्रण गर्नु वा निर्देशन गर्नु हो । अहिले तपाईंको जीवनलाई कुन शक्तिले निर्देशित गरिरहेको छ ? सायद हुन सक्छ समस्याले र दबाबले दुःखपूर्ण सम्भनाले, कुनै कुराको दासत्वले, डरत्रासले वा अहिले कोरोना कहरेले, आर्थिक समस्याले वा अन्धविश्वासले । हुन सक्छ हजारौं कुराहरूले । प्रिय मित्र यहाँ केही मुख्य कुराहरू छन् जसले तपाईंलाई निर्देशित गर्दछन्:

१. दोषहरूद्वारा चलाइएका मानिस:

उनीहरू आफू दोषी भएको महसुस गर्दछन् । उनीहरू पश्चात्तापी हुन्छन् । लाज लागिरहेको हुन्छ तर देखिँदैन । दोषले मानिसको समझलाई नष्ट गर्छ । उनीहरू बारम्बार आफू आफैँद्वारा सजायपाइरहेका हुन्छन् । उनीहरूमा भएका दोषका कारणले गर्दा आफैँ लुकेर बसेको हुन्छ । धन्य हो त्यो मानिस जसका अपराध क्षमा भएको छ र जसका पाप ढाकिएका छन् ।

२. धेरै मानिसहरू रिस, क्रोध र ईर्ष्या ले चलाइएका हुन्छन्:

जब मानिसमा रिस वा क्रोध बढेको हुन्छ तब उनीहरू हृदयमा भएको क्रोधबाट अलग्गिनै सक्दैनन् । रिसले भरिएका मानिसहरू मौका पाउनासाथ ए आपसमा पोख्छन् जुन ज्यादै नराम्रो हुन्छ । मानिसले आफ्नो रिसलाई नियन्त्रण गर्न नसकेको कारणले ठूलो नोक्सानी भोग्नुपरेका घटना हामीले आँखैअगाडि कति देखेका छौं कति । रिसले जहिल्यै दुःख दिन्छ, रिस शत्रु हो । तपाईंको भूतकाल बितिसक्यो, त्यो कहिल्यै परिवर्तन हुँदैन । बरु आफैँलाई त्यसले तितो बनाइरहन्छ । रिसले मूर्खलाई माछा अनि ईर्ष्याले सोझाहरूलाई, तर प्रेमले जीवन बदल्छ ।

३. धेरै मानिसहरू डर र भयले चलाइएका हुन्छन्:

अहिले सारा संसार कोरोनाभाइरसको चपेटामा परेको बेला सारा मानिस, वैज्ञानिकहरू यसको औषधीउपचारमा लागिपरेका छन् । तर सबै मानिस डर र त्रासले निस्सासिएका छन् । डर चाहिँ नचाहिँदो अनुभव वा हुन नसक्ने कुराको आशाको उपज हो । डर बढ्दै जाने प्रक्रिया हो । डरले सधैं आउने मौकाहरूलाई गुमाउँछ । डरको कारणले मानिसमा मनोवैज्ञानिक असर पारेको छ । कति मानिसले त आफ्नो जीवन समेत नष्ट पारेका छन् । डरले आफैँ जेलमा भएको जस्तो बनाउँछ । तर हामी विश्वास र प्रेममा चल्यो पर्दछ । प्रेममा डर हुँदैन किनभने सिद्ध प्रेमले डरलाई हटाउँछ । डरको सम्बन्ध दण्डसँग हुन्छ । जसले मलाई शक्ति दिनुहुन्छ, उहाँमा नै म सबै कुरा गर्न सक्छु । तपाईंसँग जे छ, जस्तो छ त्यही नै प्रयोग गर्नुहोस् । जे गर्न सकिन्छ त्यही गरेर देखाऔं । जहाँ छौं, जुन अवस्थामा छौं त्यहीँबाट नयाँ काम गरौं ।

४. धेरै मानिस भौतिकवादले चलाइएका हुन्छन्:

धेरै मानिस भौतिक चीजहरूको मात्र पछि लाग्दछन् । भौतिक चीजहरू हामीलाई चाहिन्छ तर सबै कुरालाई बिसरि यस कुराको मात्र पछि लाग्नु राम्रो होइन । धेरै मानिस भन्फन् भौतिक कुराहरू मात्र चाहन्छन् र त्यसको निम्ति मात्र अगाडि बढ्छन् । भौतिक कुरा हाम्रो लागि चाहिन्छ तर तिनीको चाहना राख्दाराख्दै हामी आफै तिनीको दास बन्नुचाहिँ हुँदैन । तपाईंको जीवनका लागि मोबाइल, टिभी, रुपियाँपैसा र पढाइभन्दा पहिला हाम्रो सृष्टिकर्ता हो । तपाईंको जीवनको मालिक उहाँ हुनुहुन्छ । भौतिकताले धेरै खुसी, धेरै सुविधा, धेरै सुरक्षा चाहन्छ तर सम्पत्तिले अस्थायी खुसी मात्र दिन्छ ।

५. धेरै मानिस आवश्यकताको सहमतिद्वारा चलाइएका हुन्छन्:

यस्ता मानिसहरू अरूका आवश्यकताको महसुस गर्दछन् । बुबा, आमा, छोराछारी, श्रीमान् श्रीमती, शिक्षक र साथीद्वारा आफ्नो जीवन चलोस् भन्ने चाहन्छन् । तर यो सधैं सम्भव हुने कुरै होइन । एउटा भनाइ नै छ: "विफल हुनुको कारण हो सबैलाई खुसी पार्न प्रयास गर्नु ।" कसैले दुई मालिकको सेवा गर्न सक्दैन किनभने त्यसले एउटालाई घृणार अर्कोलाई प्रेम गर्ने गर्छ । यहाँ अर्को पनि शक्ति छ, जसले मृत्युमा पुर्‍याउँछ । जस्तो अनावश्यक भार, दबाव हुन सक्ने सम्भावना, अपुरो जीवन आदि । यो विश्वास, प्रेम र शान्तिको लक्ष्यपछि तपाईंको जीवन अरु कुनै उद्देश्यको निम्ति र यसबाट विभिन्न आशीषहरू पाउनुहुनेछ ।

क. तपाईं जीवनको अर्थ जब थाहा पाउनुहुन्छ अनि मात्र जीवनमा आइपर्ने सबै अवस्था भोग्न तयार हुनुहुन्छ । लक डाउनको समयमा कोरोना कहरको कारणले गर्दा धेरै मानिसमा मनोवैज्ञानिक समस्या, घरायसी समस्या, घरेलु हिंसा, आत्महत्याजस्ता घटना भएका छन् । जसको कारणले जीवनलाई राम्रो सँग नबुझेको कारणले हो । हाम्रो जीवनको लक्ष्य हामीलाई थाहा हुनुपर्छ । लक्ष्यविना जीवनको अर्थ हुँदैन र कुनै आशा पनि हुँदैन । आशा उद्देश्यबाट आउँछ । तपाईं आशाविहीन हुनुहुन्छ भने पर्खनुहोस् तपाईंमा आशा आउँछ । परमेश्वरले योजनाहरू मानिसका लागि बनाइदिएको हो र परमेश्वरका ती योजना मानिसका नोकसानीका लागि होइनन् उन्नति र भविष्यका लागि हुन् ।

ख. जीवनको उद्देश्य थाहा पाउँ र जीवनलाप यथाशक्य सरल बनाउँ । यसले तपाईंले के गर्नु पर्छ र के गर्नु पर्दैन भन्ने कुरा थाहा गराउँछ । तपाईंको उद्देश्य विशेष हुन्छ । तपाईंले गरेका क्रियाकलापले तपाईंले आफैलाई मूल्यांकन गर्न सक्नुहुन्छ ।

ग. उद्देश्य थाहा पाएर सोअनुसार जीवनलाई केन्द्रित गर्न सकिन्छ । तपाईंको शक्तिलाई जुन काम गर्न महत्त्वपूर्ण छ, त्यसैमा केन्द्रित गर्नुपर्छ । मानवप्रकृतिलाई सानातिना कुराले पनि आफ्नो मार्गबाट अन्यत्र डोहोर्‍याउँछ । स्पष्ट उद्देश्यविना तपाईंले आफ्नो निर्देशनलाई बदल्नुहुन्छ । अनि तपाईं खाली (रित्तो) भएको महसुस गर्नु हुन्छ । त्यसैले हामीले जीवनको अर्थलाई राम्रो सँग बुझौं र आफू, आफ्नो परिवार, समाज र राष्ट्रलाई समुन्नत बनाउने प्रयत्न गरौं । जीवनलाई सार्थक बनाऔं ।

परिवर्तन ल्याऊ

- अस्मिता अधिकारी

अमेरिका, अस्ट्रेलिया जाँदैमा,
टुटेफुटेको अङ्ग्रेजी बोल्दैमा,
पश्चिमी संस्कृतिलाई पछ्याउँदैमा,
आफूलाई आधुनिक सम्झनेहरू देखेर अचम्म लाग्छ ।
आधुनिक बन्नलाई त सोचमा परिवर्तन ल्याऊँ ॥

एउटी नारी बलात्कृत हुँदा उसको पहिरनमा, उसको यौनिकतामा, उसको चरित्रमा
आँला उठाउनेहरू देखेर अचम्म लाग्छ ।
यौन पेसा अपनाएकी नारीलाई पनि जबर्जस्ती गरिन्छ भने त्यो बलत्कार नै हो
नारी धर्ती हुन्, लक्ष्मी हुन् भनेर नारीलाई दिइने सम्मान कागजमा मात्र सीमित पार्ने हो र?
नारीलाई लाई हेर्ने दृष्टिकोणमा परिवर्तन ल्याऊँ ॥

सुनारले बनाएको सुन लगाएर मख्ख पर्नेहरू,
सुनार बसेको ठाउँ सुनपानी छर्केर चोखो पार्नेहरू,
कर्मठले बनाएका भाँडाकुँडा, हातहतियार चलाएरै कमाइ गर्नेहरू
तिनै कर्मठलाई घृणा र छोइछिटो गर्नेहरू देखेर अचम्म लाग्छ ।
आफू जस्तै काम गर्ने अर्काले गरेको काममा सम्मान गर्न अरुमा हैन अब आफैमा परिवर्तन ल्याऊँ ॥

शिक्षाले अन्धकारलाई मेटाउँछ भनिरहँदा,
शिक्षित र सम्पन्न भनेकैहरू, पुरोहित र पण्डितकै पगरी लगाएकाहरू,
दाइजो, दान र विभेदमा निर्लिप्त देख्दा अचम्म लाग्छ ।
हामी पढेलेखेका भन्नेहरू! जाऊँ अब आफ्नै ज्ञानका सरोबरमा नुहाएर आफूले आफैलाई परिवर्तन गरौं
हामीहामीमा परिवर्तन ल्याऔं अनि समाज आफै परिवर्तित हुनेछ ॥

मानसिक रोग

- सदीक्षा श्रेष्ठ (नेपाल)

मान्छेहरुमा मानसिक धेरै रोग हुँदो रहेछ
त्यही रोग नै अन्त्यमा महावियोग हुँदो रहेछ
एउटै मानसिक रोग पनि हदैसम्म खतरा
भन्छन् मान्छे कसैकसैलाई त ढोङ्ग हुँदो रहेछ ॥

रोग सबैको कर्मले प्राप्त हुने कतै
मान्छेले मान्छेलाई थोपर्ने संयोग हुँदो रहेछ
कसैले बौलाहा भन्छन् कसैले नाटक गर्छ
रोगका नाममा यहाँ मान्छेकै प्रयोग हुँदो रहेछ ॥

राख्छन् रोगी बन्धनमा पीडा सहिनसक्नु
चिकित्सा सेवाको अभाव अभिशाप हुँदो रहेछ
सही चिकित्सा नपाउँदा जिन्दगी नै
आफ्नै लागि अनौठो बोझ हुँदो रहेछ ॥

सम्भन्ना घण्टाघर

- नवीन गौतम

बुढो गोरुको कचेरा चेहरा पारेर
कक्रिएको जङ्गलमा उभिरहेका
रानीपोखरीको तलाहरु किनार
भुइँचालाले उजाडिएको
भारैभारले जे लिएको गणेशमानको
शालिक पूर्वपट्टि एउटा उदास मनसँगै
उन्निरहन्छु, म घण्टाघर ।
सहरको धुलोले मलाई बेस्सरी चिथोर्छ
रत्नपार्क वरिपरिका अश्लील दृश्यहरु
देख्दा बुद्धका आँखा चिम्लिदिऊँ लाग्छ
राजनीतिका लाठीमुङ्गो मेरो खुट्टै
अगाडि बज्रिन्छन् र बज्राबज्री चलिरहन्छ
घरिघरि मेरा पाँसुलाका ईटाहरु दुख्ने गरी
हानिँदा म मर्नु न बाँच्नु हुन्छु तर पनि उभिरहन्छु ।
वीर समसेरले युरोपबाट ल्याउँदा
मेरो लहलहाउँदो उमेर त्यही त्रिचन्द्र कलेज वरिपरि
दुई प्रेम नव यौवनसँग आफ्नो घण्टाका
काँटाहरुसँग
घुमाए होलान्
मेरो टोपी त्यो गजुरमाथि
प्रकृतिको वनचरी वसन्तको कोकिल आवाजसँग
मेरो ट्वाङ्क घण्टीलाई सङ्गीत बनाई
प्रीत साटे होला
अहिले ती चराहरु बस्ने घरहरुमा
अलिसान महलहरु ठडिएका छन् ।
मसँग ती प्रीत साट्ने चराहरु उडिगएपछि
यो सहरमा नब्बे सालको आगोले पोलेको
बुढो शरीर
शिथिल मुद्रामा
अनुहार चाउरी पारेर

मरिसकेको साथी हेरिरहन्छु म घण्टाघर ।
अहिले, मेरो शरीर छिद्रछिद्र छ
माकुराले जालो लगाएको छ
मेरो तालुमा नयाँ घाउहरु छन्
मेरो भुँडीभित्र चुडिएका आन्द्राहरु
जोड्दै गणेश सापकोटा दाइ
दम दिँदै बासी खाना खुवाउँछन्
यो सहरमा चौरासी व्यञ्जन खान्छ र डर्काछ ।
अनि मलाई हेर्छन् सहरबासी
मेरो खुट्टामा चिसो दिनानुदिन पस्दै गइरहेको छ
म रोगग्रत छु
मेरो निर्जीव शरीर अव त कति नै दिन बचाउन
सक्छु र ?
मलाई त्यो गणेश दाइ विश्वकर्मा पूजाको दिन पारी
धूपध्वार गर्दछन् विचरा ऊ पनि
जहान परिवार भएको मान्छे
उसैको थोरै मायामा बाँचेको छ
ऊ पनि मलाई छोडी गएपछि
म पनि उ जस्तै छोडी जान्छु होला
थोरै छिटाछिटोले के गर्नु र !
त्यतिखेर मलामी मान्छेहरु
दुई थोपा आँसु भारेर समयको महत्त्व खोज्दो हो
त्यो क्षण यो काठमाडौँको बिचैमा लम्पासार मेरो शरीर
स्याल र ब्याँसाहरुले लुहेर टुक्राटुक्रा पारी आफ्नो
पेट भर्दा हुनन् ।
मेरो घण्टाको आवाज इतिहासमा कैदी जीवन
बिताउँदो हो
म स्वर्गबासी हुँदो हुँ
मलाई स्वर्गीय घण्टाघर भन्दा हुन्
यहाँको सहरबासीहरु ।

म र मनको कुरा

- श्रीराम लवजु

शून्यता;

बोल्नु पर्ला भनेर
गल्ती बोलिएला सोचेर
एउटा डर भो ।

मौनता;

कि सबै थाहा पाएर
कि थाहा नै नभएर
एउटा स्वर भो ।

शान्त माहोल;

गरिदिन्छ भन्ने आश गरेर
कि गरिदिनुपर्छ नै मानेर
एउटा भर भो ।

निराशा;

गर्दै गरेको कुरा नबनेर
भन्दै गरेको कम नसकेर
एउटा घर भो ।

वितृष्णा;

तलमाथि सिको नजानेर
हरकुरामा मापन लिएर
एउटा दर भो ।

रहर मनको अनौठो पाटो

- श्रीराम लवजु

सानो बेलामा सबैले आआफ्ना रहर सुनाउने गर्थे । म ज्ञानी भएर, एकदम मज्जाले सुन्ने गर्थे । तर जब मेरो भन्ने पालो आउँथ्यो नि रातोपिरो हुन्थे, नुन खाएको कुखुराजस्तै भोक्राएर लुकेर बस्थे र मनमनै गुनगुनाउँथे "उफ् केही बहाना होस् न मैले बोल्न नपरोस्, कि त कसैले पालो मिचिदिए नि हुन्थ्यो" । अनि बोल्ने परेपछि के भन्थे भने भाग्यमा के छ त्यस्तै हो, कस्तीमा हासिरहन पाए निकै खुसी हुन्थे । कस्तो कुरा गर्छ यो केटो भनेर सबै हाँस्थे, म पनि मिस्रित हाँसो दिन्थे, कुरा सकिन्थ्यो ।

यस्ता रहरहरू सोच्दै गर्दा अनेक कुरा मनमा नि नआएको हैन । मलाई पनि गफ दिउँ लाग्थ्यो तर कुराहरू यस्तै त हो भनेर वास्ता गर्दिनथे । पाइलट बनुँजस्तो लाग्थ्यो तर त्यहीँ तोरीबारीमा हात फिजाएर गाली खाँदै कुदेको बाहेक केही थाहा छैन । भुनूँ त अकाशमा उडेको हवाई जहाज हेर्न बाहेक मज्जा पाइलट बन्छुमा छैन सोच्थे । डाक्टर बन्छु भन्यो भने नि घरमा मजाक नै बन्थे । बिरामी पर्दा त्यहीँ वैद्यबाको भारफुक जलपानी, अक्षता, कुचोबाट निको हुन्थे । जतिसुकै सिकिस्त भए पनि आमाको न्यानो काखमा निको हुने म । अब इन्जिनियर बनुँ भन्यो भनै त्यो त औकात बाहिरकै गफ हुन्थ्यो । यस्तै गीत गाउने गायक बनुँ भन्यो भने स्वर सुरु भयो कि भेडा कराएजस्तै हसाउने पाराको आवाज आउँथ्यो आफ्नै । त्यसमा रुचि जाने कुरै भएन । भन्दै गर्दा नाच्ने भने पनि कुरा त्यहीँ त हो । उतिबेलाको लोडसेडिङ हुने समयमा बत्ती आयो, बत्ती गयो भनेर उफ्रने बाहेक केही नआउने । मास्टर भएर विद्यार्थीहरू पढाउँजस्तो नि लाग्थ्यो । फेरि मनमा आउँथ्यो - मजस्तो जति पढाए नि नबुझ्ने विद्यार्थीहरूलाई कसरी पढाउने होला? यस्तै कुरा सोचेरै जाँगर मर्थ्यो । रहर त थुप्रै हुन्थे यही मेरो सबभन्दा प्रिय भनेर नै सदाजसो अन्योलमै पर्थे ।

रहरहरू कसैका लागि खुल्ला अकाश लाग्थे होला । मलाई चाहिँ बगिरहेको खोलामा डुङ्गा चलाएभँ लाग्थ्यो । छान्दै गर्दा, मनदेखि बुझ्दै गर्दा, मेरो अन्तरआत्मामा चैं म राम्रोसँग पढाइमा ध्यान दिन नसके पनि बस् सधैं पढ्न पाए ठिक हुन्छ लागिहन्थ्यो । विद्यालय सकिँदा, स्नातक तहसम्मको पढाइ सकिँदा, अभ्र भुनूँ जागिर खाइरहँदा धेरैजसो ठूलो मुन्छेकै कुरामा जोड दिए । पानी बगेतिर डुङ्गा खियाउँदा सजिलोसँग समयसँगै गन्तव्य सहजमा पुगिन्छ यस्तै मनमा लाग्थे ।

सोच्ने आआफ्नै तरिका होला, मलाई चैं खास रहर नलिईकन अगाडि बढिरहँदा उस्तो कुनै नरमाइलो लागेन । कसैकसैलाई फेरि रहरकै बारेमा सोध्ने । मेरा प्रश्नले मानिसहरू अभ्रै अवक न बक्क हुन्छन् । अकाशमा उडिरहेको चङ्गा जस्तै हुन मनको रहरहरू । हावाको दिशा, समय, परिस्थिति, तगारा, सीमितता आदि कुराहरूबाट सधैं प्रभावित हुन्छन् । त्यसमाथि म आफैलाई कमजोर ठान्ने, खास रहर लिएर म थप फन्फटमा पर्न नसक्ला भन्ने पिर हुन्छ र पो ! रहर एउटा अडिग हुनै नसक्ने मनको पाटो ।

नेपालमा मनोसामाजिक समस्या र सेवाको उपलब्धता

- शरदचन्द्र न्यौपाने

१. मनोसामाजिक समस्या:

नेपाली जनमानसमा भेट हुँदा सोधिने सामान्य शिष्टाचार भनेको सञ्चै ? आरामै हुनुहुन्छ ? आदि हुन् । सञ्चै वा आरामैले सामान्यतः शारीरिक स्वास्थ्यलाई जनाउने गर्दछ र हामी शारीरिक सञ्चोविसञ्चोकै आधारमा प्रत्युक्ति दिन्छौ । मानसिक स्वास्थ्य हाम्रो प्राथमिकतामा नपर्ने वा मानसिक स्वास्थ्यलाई हाम्रो स्वास्थ्यको महत्त्वपूर्ण पाटोका रूपमा नबुझिने र मानसिक स्वास्थ्य समस्या यसै ओभेलमा रहँदै आएको छ । हाम्रो शरीरमा चोटपटक वा शारीरिक अङ्गको काम गराइमा कुनै समस्या आउँदा हामीले जसरी सहज रूपमा हाम्रो स्वास्थ्य समस्या भनेर बुझ्दछौ, मानसिक स्वास्थ्यमा आउने विचलन र विकारलाई स्वास्थ्य समस्याका रूपमा त्यसरी सहज रूपमा बुझिँदैन । राज्यले पनि आफ्ना स्वास्थ्य सेवासम्बन्धी जिम्मेवार निकाय र संरचना तथा अस्पताल, स्वास्थ्य चौकी र उपस्वास्थ्य चौकीमा शारीरिक स्वास्थ्यलाई जति प्राथमिकतामा राखेको छ त्यति मानसिक स्वास्थ्यलाई प्राथमिकतामा राखेको पाइँदैन ।

मानिसको भौतिक शरीरबाहेक शरीरभित्र मन, भावना, प्रेम, करुणा पनि हुन्छन् । मानिसको जीवनशैली, सामाजिक वातावरण आदिले मानिसको व्यवहारमा परिवर्तन आउन थाल्छ । मानिस सामाजिक प्राणी हो । मन र समाजबीचको सम्बन्धलाई मनोसामाजिक भनिन्छ । मनको पीडा बुझिदिने वा आफ्ना पीडा, विचार सुनिदिने कोही भएन भने आफ्ना भावनाहरू कुण्ठित हुन्छन् । भावना, विचार, विश्वास, बुझाइ संवेग र सामाजिक परिवेशको नतिजास्वरूप मानिसमा मनोसामाजिक समस्या आउन सक्छ । यसका विभिन्न रूपहरू हुन्छन् । जसलाई हामी मानसिक स्वास्थ्य भन्दछौ ।

मानसिक स्वास्थ्यका विभिन्न आयामहरू हुन्छन् । मनमा चिन्ता, पीर, एक्लोपन, भर्को मान्ने, कसैसँग नजिक हुन मन नगर्ने, एकाग्र हुन नसक्ने, डराउने र निरीह महसुस गर्ने हुन सक्छ । निन्द्रामा गडबडी हुने, चिटचिट पसिना आउने, थकान महसुस हुने, खान मन नलाग्ने रिंगटा लाग्ने आदि पनि हुन सक्छ । कसैलाई एकोहोरो टोहोलाउने, ध्यान केन्द्रित गर्न नसक्ने र निष्क्रिय व्यवहार पनि देखिन सक्छ । कतिपय अवस्थामा डराउने, तर्सने, नबोल्ने, आवश्यकता भन्दा बढी डराउने पनि हुन सक्छ ।

कोविड १९ को विश्वव्यापी महामारीले नेपालमा चैत्र २०७७ देखि अहिलेसम्मका दिनहरूमा चर्कै प्रभाव पारिरहेकै छ । भ्याक्सिन आइनुपुगेको कारण मानिसलाई जति संकटमा धकेलेको छ त्यो भन्दा बढी मानसिक सन्त्रास थपेको छ । विभिन्न महामारी, विपत्ति र दैवी प्रकोपका बेला मानिसहरूमा मनोसामाजिक समस्या थपिने गरेको छ । मानिसहरूमा त्रास, असुरक्षा र विभिन्न मानिसहरूको मृत्युको समाचारले चिन्ता बढेको पाइन्छ । अझ आइसोलेसनमा बसेकाहरूमा एक्लोपन महसुस हुने र मनोसामाजिक समस्या बढेको समाचारहरू आइरहेका छन् ।

२. समुदायमा मनोसामाजिक सेवाका लागि उपलब्ध सेवाहरू

मुलुकको स्वास्थ्य अवस्थाको मापक शारीरिक स्वास्थ्य मात्र होइन । नागरिकको मानसिक स्वास्थ्यले राष्ट्रको स्वास्थ्य अवस्था निर्धारण गर्दछ । मानसिक स्वास्थ्यलाई जनस्वास्थ्यको महत्वपूर्ण हिस्साका रूपमा लिइ सही नीति, कार्ययोजना र सेवा दिनु सरकारको दायित्व हो । जनसत्ताको ठूलो हिस्सा मानसिक स्वास्थ्यबाट प्रभावित छ । तर न्युन मात्रामा औषधी नै चलाउनुपर्ने अवस्थाका बिरामी मात्र स्वास्थ्य सेवा लिन अस्पताल जाने गरेको पाइन्छ । मनोविमर्श सेवा दिने संस्थाहरू त नगन्य मात्रामा रहेका पाइन्छन् । ग्रामीण समुदायमा मनोसामाजिक तथा मानसिक स्वास्थ्य समस्याका बिरामीहरू परम्परागत उपचार, धामी भौँत्रीका उपचारमा अल्मलिएर जटिल अवस्था सिर्जना भएपछि मात्र अस्पताल आउने गरेको पाइन्छ ।

नागरिकको मानसिक स्वास्थ्यलाई हेर्ने सरकारी दृष्टिकोण स्पष्ट छैन । सामान्यतः पागल भन्दिने र मनोचिकित्सकको सेवा मात्र आवश्यक देख्ने गल्ती गरिन्छ । नेपालका विभिन्न समुदायमा साङ्गले बाँधेर राख्ने, उपचारको आवश्यकता महसुस नगर्ने र शारीरिक स्वास्थ्यलाई प्राथमिकतामा नराख्ने अवस्था छ । सरकारको पनि यसलाई नियमन र व्यवस्थापन गर्ने विषयमा अन्योल छ ।

छ महिनाको मनोविमर्शको तालिम लिएर रुकुममा कार्यरत इन्दिरा आचार्यका अनुसार ग्रामीण क्षेत्रमा मनोसामाजिक समस्या आम रूपमा छ । विशेष गरी घरेलु हिंसा, लैङ्गिक हिंसा, दाइजोका कारण, गरिबीका कारण, यौनशोषणका कारण, जातीय र आर्थिक कमजोर समुहलाई गरिने हेलाहोचोका कारण पनि मनोसामाजिक समस्या बढ्दो अवस्थामा र आममानिसमा रहेको पाइन्छ । आचार्यसँग मनोसामाजिक सेवा लिन आउनेमध्ये ९० प्रतिशत महिला छन् । तर स्थानीय नगरपालिका, स्वास्थ्य चौकीसँगको अन्तरक्रियामा मनोसामाजिक स्वास्थ्यसेवाको आवश्यकता रहेको महसुस गरे पनि सेवा उपलब्धता गराउने तत्परता पाइँदैन । गैरसरकारी क्षेत्रमा सीमित मानवीय स्रोतले मात्र सेवा दिइरहेको अवस्था छ ।

वीरगन्ज महानगरको ३१ वडामा रहेको सामुदायिक स्वास्थ्य एकाइमा एक अनमी, एक अहेब र एक कार्यलय सहायकसहित तीन कर्मचारी कार्यरत छन् । कार्यरत अनमीका अनुसार त्यहाँ खोप, पोषण र अन्य शारीरिक स्वास्थ्यको जाँच र औषधीको व्यवस्था छ तर मानसिक स्वास्थ्यका बारेमा कुनै बन्दोबस्तै छैन । समुदाय स्तरमा राज्य तहबाट व्यवस्थापन भएका यस्ता स्वास्थ्य एकाइहरूको सेवाको बारेमा ती अनमीको आवाज प्रतिनिधिमूलक मान्ने हो भने पनि समुदाय तहका सबै स्वास्थ्य एकाइहरूमा मानसिक स्वास्थ्य सेवा प्राथमिकतामा छैन अथवा मानसिक स्वास्थ्य सेवाको उपलब्ध नै छैन भन्न सकिन्छ ।

मनोसामाजिक समस्यामा थप मलजल कोविड १९ ले पनि गरेको छ । अहिलेको अवस्थामा समुदायमा मनोसामाजिक समस्याका आकलन र मद्दतका लागि व्यवस्थापन गर्नुपर्ने देखिन्छ । यसबाट हामीले कसलाई र कस्तो उपचार सेवाको आवश्यकता छ वा छैन भन्ने निक्कै गर्न सकौं । त्यसपछि आकस्मिक उपचार चाहिने, सामान्य वा विशिष्ट विमर्शसेवा चाहिने वा मनोचिकित्सकको परामर्शको लागि लैजानुपर्ने आदिलाई वर्गीकरण गरी उपचारको तयारी गर्न सकिन्छ ।

मानसिक स्वास्थ्य अहिलेको प्राथमिकतामा पर्नुपर्ने हो, तर प्रति एक लाख जनसङ्ख्यामा ०.२२ मनोचिकित्सक, ०.०६ मनोविद् र ०.५९ मानसिक स्वास्थ्य कार्यकर्ता मात्र भएकोबाट मानसिक स्वास्थ्य सेवाको अवस्था कति दयनीय होला यसै आकलन गर्न सकिन्छ । राज्यले मानसिक स्वास्थ्यमा गरेको लगानी सबै स्वास्थ्यक्षेत्रको तुलनामा दयनीय छ । शिक्षण अस्पताल भएका सहरहरू काठमाडौँ, धरान, चितवन, पोखरा, वीरगन्ज र नेपालगन्जमा मनोचिकित्सक सेवा पाइन्छ । तर अन्य सहर र ग्रामीण इलाकामा मनोचिकित्सकको सेवाको उपलब्धता छैन भने हुन्छ । मनोविमर्शकर्ता सेवा सहर क्षेत्रमा केहीले व्यावसायिक संस्थाकै रूपमा दिइरहेका छन् भने विभिन्न सामाजिक संस्थाहरूले पनि मनोविमर्श सेवा दिइरहेका छन् । ग्रामीण इलाकामा सामाजिक संस्थाहरूको पहलमा विभिन्न परियोजनामार्फत मनोविमर्श सेवा दिइरहेको पाइन्छ । तर ग्रामीण स्तरमा रहेका स्वास्थ्य चौकी तथा उपस्वास्थ्य चौकीमा मनोविमर्शको सेवाको उपलब्धता छैन ।

३. मनोसामाजिक विमर्शकर्ताको अध्ययन र तालिम

औपचारिक अध्ययनको हिसाबले त्रिभुवन विश्वविद्यालयमा मनोविज्ञानको अध्ययन हुन्छ । त्रिविविको मनोविज्ञान विभागमा दुई वर्षको मनोविज्ञान विषयको स्नातकोत्तर विषयको अध्यापन अध्ययन हुन्छ । त्रिविविले त्रिचन्द्र कलेजमा एक वर्ष पोष्ट ग्राजुएट काउन्सिलिङ साइकोलोजीको पनि पढाइ गर्दछ । त्रिविविको चिकित्सा विज्ञान अध्ययन संस्थानमा क्लिनिकल साइकोलोजीको एम फिलको पढाइ हुन्छ । जहाँबाट क्लिनिकल साइकोलोजिस्ट हुने लाइसेन्स प्राप्त हुन्छ । सन् १९९९ देखि सुरु भएको उक्त विषयमा हालसम्म ५० भन्दा कम व्यक्ति क्लिनिकल साइकोलोजिस्टका रूपमा जनशक्ति उत्पादित छ ।

केही गैरसरकारी संस्थाहरूले पनि तालिम दिएर मनोविमर्शकर्ताहरू उत्पादन गर्ने र समुदायमा परियोजनाका रूपमा काम गर्ने गरेको पाइन्छ । त्यस्ता तालिमहरू छोटामा एक हप्तादेखि छ महिनासम्मका रहेका पाइन्छन् भने तालिमहरूबाट प्रशिक्षित भएका मनोविमर्शकर्ता विभिन्न ठाउँमा संस्थागत तरिकाले कार्यरत रहने गरेका पाइन्छन् । यस्ता मनोविमर्श तालिम दिने संस्थाहरूमा सिभिकट, टीपीओ, तरङ्गिनी फाउन्डेसनलगायत छन् । यसरी तालिम लिएर समुदायमा काम गर्ने मनोविमर्शकर्ताहरूका पनि आफ्नै समस्या छन् ।

४. मनोसामाजिक समस्याको सेवामा देखिएका समस्याहरू र आवश्यकता

मनोसामाजिक समस्यालाई बुझ्ने र यो पनि समस्या हो भनेर राज्यले लगानी गरेको अवस्था पाइँदैन । सरकारी र निजी क्षेत्रमा मनोसामाजिक समस्यामा सेवा दिने संस्थाहरू न्यून रहेका छन् । यो समस्यामा काम गर्ने व्यावसायिक मानवस्रोत पनि न्यून रहेको अवस्था छ । तालिम लिएर समुदाय स्तरमा सेवा दिइरहेको जनशक्तिको सेवा अपर्याप्त छ । उनीहरू दिनभर सेवा दिने र निरन्तर काम गरिरहँदा सेवाग्राहीका पीडा सुन्दा सुन्दा आफैँ पीडित भएको अवस्था छ । उनहरूलाई आवश्यक टेवा खाँचो छ । सरकारले सञ्चालन गरेका विभिन्न तहका अस्पताल र स्वास्थ्यचौकीहरूमा आवश्यक मानवस्रोतको अभाव वा दरबन्दी नै नरहेका कारण मानसिक स्वास्थ्य सेवाबाट आममानिस वञ्चित हुनुपरेको छ ।

निष्कर्षमा भन्नुपर्दा मनोसामाजिक क्षेत्रमा काम गर्ने मानवस्रोतको विकास गर्नुपर्ने आवश्यकता देखिन्छ । प्रत्येक स्थानीय तहका वडाहरूमा कम्तीमा एकजना मनोविमर्श कर्ता, प्रत्येक स्थानीय तहमा उनीहरूभन्दा एक तह माथिका अनुगमनकर्ता वा मनोविदको व्यवस्था आवश्यक छ । जिल्ला र क्षेत्रीय तहमा उच्च अध्ययन भएका मनोविद्, मनोचिकित्सक, क्लिनिकल साइकोलोजिस्टको व्यवस्था गर्नुपर्ने आवश्यकता देखिन्छ । स्वाभाविक रूपमा यी आवश्यकतापूर्तिका लागि मानस्रोतको विकास गर्न आधारभूत तथा विशिष्टीकृत तालिम एवं अध्ययन गर्ने संस्थाहरूको पनि विकास गर्नुपर्ने देखिन्छ ।

सन्दर्भ सामग्री

<https://lapsoj.org/rishav-koirala>.

भट्टराई रवीन्द्र, गुरुङ्ग भूपेन्द्र सिंह, मनोसामाजिक समस्या: आकलन, मद्दत र विमर्श, एसियन एकेडेमी फर पिस, रिसर्च एन्ड डेभलपमेन्ट, काठमाडौं, २०७७

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Obituary



Nisha Adhikari Dhakal (35 Yrs.) passed away on 18-12-2077 in Kathmandu in post operation state following minor surgery and as we learnt it that she was no more we were shocked and saddened. She was studying Counseling Psychology in PGDCP Batch 2077 with us and she was one of the keen and good fellow of us. Her death has taken away a genuinely warm individual, more importantly, a loving mother, wife, and daughter, and deprived so many others.

People may tell us that it was all part of God's plan, or was just Nisha's time to go, that she is in a better place but we cry out that while God certainly knows his plan, we do not. She may indeed be in a better place now, but we want her to be here with us. We mourned following her demise and condoled the family who borne most painful and difficult and painful time with irreparable loss.

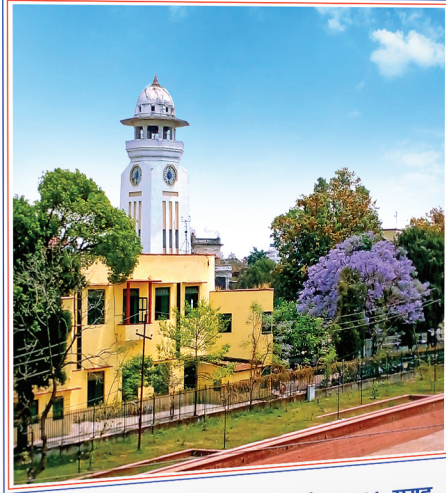
Our tribute Nisha!!! You will always remain in our memories.

**Post Graduate Diploma in Counseling
Psychology 2021 Batch**

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्मारिका



विमर्श मनोविज्ञान स्नातकोत्तर डिप्लोमा २०७७ समूह
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